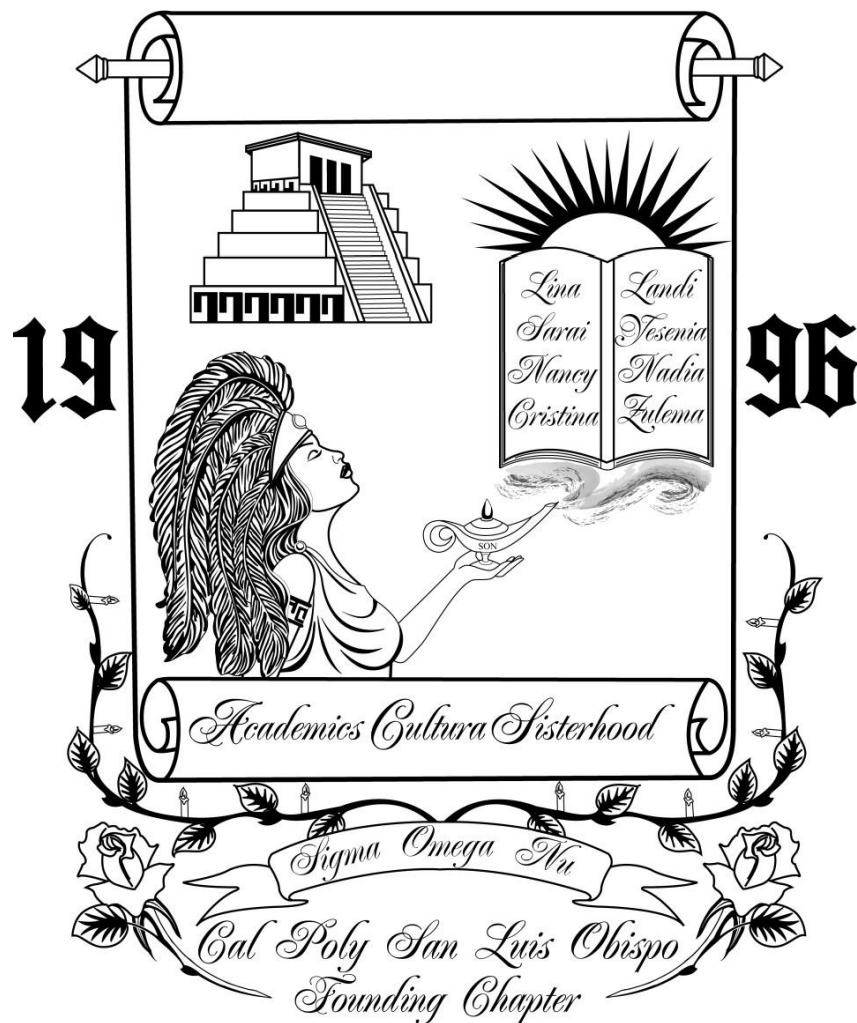


Sigma Omega Nu

Latina Interest Sorority, Inc.



Standardized Pledgeship

Standardized Pledgeship

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Sigma Omega Nu Latina Interest Sorority, Inc. Standardized Pledgeship

Article I. Purpose

The purpose of the Big Sister Little Sister (BSLS) process and the associated pledgeship assignments is to foster unity between Big Sisters and Little Sisters, to educate Little Sisters on how to be positive, contributing Sisters of the Chapter, and to assess their knowledge of Sigma Omega Nu's history, facts, and relevant organizational information and procedures.

The Big Sister Little Sister process will be subject to amendment or modification as required to ensure compliance with applicable university policies, rules, and regulations. Any such changes must be submitted to the National Board for review and formal verification prior to implementation.

All aspects of the process must be conducted in strict accordance with university policies. In instances where any provision of this process conflicts with university requirements, such conflicts must be reported promptly to the National Board, which will provide guidance or directive resolution as appropriate.

Article II. Pledge Committee

Section A. Purpose

The elected Pledge Mother(s) are elected to guide the Pledge Class through the Big Sister Little Sister process. Following their selection and prior to the pinning ceremony, the Active Membership must elect a Pledge Committee. The Pledge Committee is responsible for advising the Pledge Mother(s) and overseeing the progress of the Pledge Class.

Section B. Membership

1. The Pledge Committee must consist of the following Chapter officers: the President, Risk Management Officer, Sergeant at Arms, and two Active Members who have expressed interest in serving as Pledge Mothers for a future class.
 - a. The Chapter President is responsible for overseeing all aspects of the Big Sister Little Sister process. Additionally, the Chapter President must ensure that all components of the process comply with sorority and university policies, and that no form of hazing occurs.
 - b. Active Members interested in serving as a Pledge Mother in a future term are eligible for the two remaining committee positions. The Active Members must elect the candidates they believe will best fill the position.
2. Active Members may voice their concerns to the Pledge Committee and/or to the Pledge Mother(s). Upon receiving a concern, the Pledge Committee and the Pledge Mother(s)

must collaborate to develop a solution within 24 to 48 hours. The Pledge Mother(s) must then add the concern and proposed solution to the agenda for the next Chapter meeting and provide an update to the Chapter at that meeting. These steps must be completed before the Pledge Mother(s) implement the proposed solution.

Article III. Identification

Section A. Process

The new member education process will be known as the Big Sister Little Sister (BSLS) Process. For the purpose of this document, the Big Sister Little Sister process will hereafter be referred to as *the process*.

Section B. Pledge Class

1. Each Pledge Class must be identified by a letter of the Greek alphabet, to be assigned in the order of the Greek alphabet. Once the Omega Class is reached, each subsequent class will be identified by two letters. For example, following Psi Class will be the Omega Class, the Alpha Alpha Class, the Alpha Beta Class, the Alpha Gamma Class, and so on. The Alpha Omega Class must be skipped in honor of deceased Sisters.
2. In the event that an entire class drops or is dropped, the next Pledge Class must repeat the Greek letter of the uninitiated class, and must not continue with the next letter in the Greek alphabet. For example, if the Theta Pledge Class drops, the next class must be recognized as the Theta Pledge Class.

Section C. Little Sisters and Big Sisters

1. Prospective New Members who are officially accepted into the Big Sister Little Sister process will be identified as Little Sisters of Sigma Omega Nu.
2. As they move through the process, Little Sisters are encouraged to refer to one another as Pledge Sisters, to foster a sense of unity and shared experience.
3. Little Sisters are also encouraged to refer to members of Sigma Omega Nu as Big Sisters, reinforcing mentorship and connection.
4. In turn, Big Sisters are encouraged to refer to members in the process as Little Sisters, affirming their role in the sorority's tradition of support and sisterhood.
5. The use of "Little Sister" and "Big Sister" is encouraged as relationships begin to form. These terms represent the mentorship, emotional support, and familial bonds that are cultivated within the sorority. The Big Sister and Little Sister relationship mirrors that of real-life sisters/siblings, a Big Sister offers guidance, support, and encouragement, much like an older sibling would, while a Little Sister looks to them for reassurance, mentorship, and a sense of belonging.
6. While encouraged, the use of the terms outlined in this section are optional, and no member will be reprimanded or penalized for choosing not to use "Little Sister", "Big Sister," or "Pledge Sister."
7. To support inclusivity and respect for all gender identities, members may choose to use the terms "Big Sibling", "Little Sibling", or "Pledge Sibling" in place of gendered language.

These alternatives carry the same meaning and are equally encouraged and respected within the organization.

Article IV. Eligibility for the Big Sister Little Sister Process

Section A. Prohibition of Discrimination

There must be no discrimination in membership based on age, appearance, creed, disability, ethnicity, national origin, marital status, parental status, political affiliation, race, religion, sexual orientation, or veteran status.

Section B. Identification

Membership in the Big Sister Little Sister process is open to all individuals who identify as women and/or non-binary.

Section C. Age Requirement

All Prospective New Members must be at least 18 years of age, the legal age of majority, prior to beginning the Big Sister Little Sister process. This requirement ensures that Prospective New Members have the legal capacity to engage in all aspects of the process, including signing forms, attending events, and participating in activities in accordance with university policies and applicable laws.

Section D. Enrollment Requirement

Prospective New Members must be currently enrolled at the university where the chapter is established, either as undergraduate or graduate students. Undergraduate students must be registered as full-time students, and graduate students must be enrolled as part-time students at the university.

Section E. Grade Point Average (GPA) Requirement

Prospective New Members must have a minimum term GPA of 2.3, a minimum cumulative GPA of 2.5, and be in good academic standing with the university both prior to and during the Big Sister Little Sister process. Prospective New members on academic probation, progress probation, or any other academic standing defined as probation by the university are not eligible to participate in the process. If the university where the chapter is established requires a higher minimum GPA, those minimum requirements must be met.

1. For transfer students, their transfer coursework and GPA must be included in calculating their cumulative GPA.
2. Prospective New Members who are in their first term of college do not yet have a university grade point average, therefore are exempt to the GPA requirement until a GPA is established at their university.

Article V. Length of Pledgeship

Section A. Minimum Length

The Big Sister Little Sister process must be a minimum of seven weeks and a maximum of nine weeks in duration for all Chapters of Sigma Omega Nu. These weeks must be active weeks, during which Little Sisters are engaging with their Pledge Mother(s) through scheduled meetings or activities. Weeks such as Finals Week, Winter Break or Spring Break, will not be counted toward the required minimum.

1. If seven weeks are insufficient to complete the process, the Active Membership may vote to extend it, so long as the total duration does not exceed the nine-week maximum.
2. Chapters must also adhere to any policies established by their university regarding new member processes. If a university imposes a maximum length or prohibits activities beyond the official end of the term, those guidelines must be followed.
3. Finals week is a protected academic period, if the process extends into Finals Week, the following stipulations apply:
 - a. No assignments will be assigned or due during finals week.
 - b. No interviews, meetings, or activities of any kind may be scheduled.
 - c. All contact between Active Members and Little Sisters during this time must be entirely optional and purely social in nature (for example, study breaks, casual check-ins, etc.).
4. During any breaks, such as Winter Break or Spring Break, the following stipulations apply:
 - a. No interviews, meetings, or activities of any kind may be scheduled.
 - b. Little Sisters may only work on independent, self-directed assignments if they choose to do so. They cannot be required to complete any group assignments during this time.
 - c. All contact between Active Members and Little Sisters during this time must be entirely optional and purely social in nature (for example, study breaks, casual check-ins, etc.).

Section B. Quarter School System

Due to the standard length of an academic quarter (typically 10 weeks) and the length of the Big Sister Little Sister process, it is likely that the process will carry over into the following academic term. Chapters operating on a quarter system must plan accordingly, ensuring that the Little Sisters have adequate time to complete the minimum seven weeks. For this reason, starting a new Pledge Class during the Spring Quarter is highly discouraged as it may not provide sufficient time for Little Sisters to complete the process before the end of the academic year. If a Spring class is proposed, Chapters must confirm that the calendar allows for the full process, including adherence to finals week restrictions.

Section C. Semester School System

Due to the standard length of an academic semester (typically 15-16 weeks) and the length of the Big Sister Little Sister process, the process must be completed within the same academic term in which it begins.

Section D. Planning Guidance

Chapters must review the university's official academic calendar prior to scheduling the Big Sister Little Sister process. This will help ensure there is sufficient time for 7-9 weeks of active engagement, excluding finals week and any university breaks or holidays. Chapters are also required to consult with their Greek Like Advisor to identify any university-specific intake timelines, or deadlines that may apply to new member processes. Proper planning promotes compliance with both university regulations and Sigma Omega Nu requirements, and supports the academic success and well-being of all members involved.

Article VI. Rush

Section A. Definition

Rush is the designated period at the beginning of each academic term during which Prospective New Members can learn more about Sigma Omega Nu and its members. This period allows individuals to make an informed decision about joining a Greek organization that aligns with their values and goals. Rush also serves as a time for the Sisters of Sigma Omega Nu to actively recruit and engage with Prospective New Members through events, conversations, and community-building activities.

Section B. Rush Week

Rush week(s) typically take place one to two weeks before the Big Sister Little Sister process begins. However, chapters, particularly those on a quarter system, may extend Rush over a longer period, such as throughout the Fall Quarter, with the Big Sister Little Sister process beginning in the Winter Quarter.

If the corresponding University has a designated Rush period for Greek Organizations, then the Chapter must schedule all Rush events within that timeframe. All Rush events and publicity efforts must comply with the university's applicable rules, regulations, and procedures.

1. **Booth and Informational Tables**

During the Rush Period, the Chapter may set up a booth or informational table on campus in a location such as the University Union Plaza. The Active Members are responsible for taking shifts to ensure that Prospective New Members have their questions and concerns answered. The booth and table must comply with all university rules, regulations, and procedures, including space reservation policies and tabling guidelines.

2. **Pamphlets and Rush Fliers**

Rush fliers containing all rush events, times, and locations must be created each time the Chapter holds Rush. These fliers are to be printed and made available at the booth or informational table, and also posted around campus in locations permitted by the University. Digital versions of rush fliers should also be created and posted on the Chapter's social media account(s). Pamphlets, containing general Sigma Omega Nu history and Chapter information should also be created and made available at the booth or informational table.

All printed and digital publicity materials created for Rush must be submitted to the National Social Media Manager for review and approval no later than two weeks prior to the start of Rush Week. If any new Rush events are added after initial approval, any associated materials must be submitted and approved before being posted or distributed.

3. Rush Events and Activities

Rush events and activities allow Prospective New Members and Sisters to interact and get to know each other. Chapters may determine the specific format and themes of these events, but they must meet the following minimum requirements:

- a. At least one (1) social with another organization
- b. One (1) sisterhood potluck, and
- c. Two (2) informationals led by the Chapter.

Events required by the university or Greek Council do not count toward the Chapter's minimum Rush event requirements.

Alcohol consumption is strictly prohibited before, during, and after any official Rush events, for all attendees, regardless of age. Chapters are expected to uphold the values of Sigma Omega Nu by creating safe, inclusive, and substance-free environments during all recruitment events/activities.

- a. Socials: Social events may be organized in two formats: exclusively between Sisters and Prospective New Members, or jointly with another organization and their Prospective New Members. These events are intended to foster casual, inclusive interactions and allow Prospective New Members to engage with the values and culture of Sigma Omega Nu.
- b. Sisterhood Potluck: The sisterhood potluck is a closed event open only to Sisters and Prospective New Members. Sisters are required to bring a dish that represents their individual cultures, traditions, or backgrounds, promoting cultural appreciation and deeper connections within the sisterhood. Sisters will share what their dish is, where it comes from (for example, family, culture, or tradition), and why it is meaningful to them. The Prospective New Members are also encouraged to participate by sharing their favorite dish, where it comes from, and why it is meaningful to them.
- c. Informationals: Informationals must be held on campus or at a location approved by the Chapter's Executive Board. Each informational must include a structured presentation covering the following required topics:
 1. The founding of Sigma Omega Nu: An overview of the sorority's history and purpose
 2. The founding of the Chapter at the corresponding university
 3. Sigma Omega Nu's Objectives, Mission and Vision
 4. Sigma Omega Nu Facts: Official colors, roses, and nicknames
 5. Chapter Events and Involvement: Annual events such as fundraisers and community service, as well as participation in campus-wide or Greek Council events
 6. Leadership and Involvement Opportunities: Positions available within the Chapter, as well as in the Greek Council

7. Benefits of Membership: Examples of personal, academic, and professional development through Sigma Omega Nu.
8. General Active Member Requirements: Expectations such as GPA minimums, weekly meetings, study hours, community service, and other responsibilities of an Active Member.
9. Active Dues: Cost breakdown (per term and per year), explanation of what dues cover, and available payment plan options.
10. Eligibility Requirements for the Big Sister Little Sister process: Application deadlines, requirement documents, interview process, and timeline.
11. Big Sister Little Sister Process Dues: Cost of dues for the Big Sister Little Sister process, explanation of what the dues include, and available payment plan options.
12. Anti-Hazing Policy: Clear statement on the Sigma Omega Nu's and university's anti-hazing policy, including expectations for respectful treatment.
13. Q&A Session: Time for Prospective New Members to ask questions and receive clarification.
14. Contact Information: Names, positions, and contact details for Chapter President and Chapter Pledge Mother(s), or those in the Pledge Committee.

Additional content may be included at the Chapter's discretion, but all required information must be presented clearly and consistently.

Article VII. Prospective New Member Application and Interview Process

Section A. Application

1. Before the conclusion of the Rush period, all individuals who have expressed interest in joining Sigma Omega Nu must complete a Prospective New Member Application. The application serves two primary purposes: to provide Active Members with greater insight into each applicant's background, goals, and values, and to collect essential information that may be required if the applicant is later invited to join the Big Sister Little Sister process. The application is only to be given out after a Prospective New Member has attended an informational. The Pledge Mother(s) are responsible for determining and clearly communicating the submission deadline for all completed applications.
2. The Prospective New Member Application must include the following information and questions:
 - a. Personal Information:
 1. Full Name
 2. Date of Birth
 3. Major/Minor
 4. Year in School

5. Phone Number
6. Email Address
- b. Questions
 1. Describe yourself in five words.
 2. What's something unique or fun we should know about you?
 3. What has been one of your most memorable or inspirational life experiences?
 4. What values are most important to you?
 5. What strategies or tools do you use to stay organized and manage your time?
 6. How many hours do you spend on coursework or studying each week?
 7. Have you been involved in other clubs, organizations, or leadership roles (on this campus, another university, or in high school)? If yes, which ones?
 8. What are your career goals?
 9. Why are you interested in joining a sorority?
 10. What about joining Sigma Omega Nu interests you?
 11. What qualities do you look for in a sisterhood?
- c. Personal preferences, a list of their favorite things:
 1. Color(s)
 2. Food(s)
 3. Drink(s)
 4. Sports Team(s)
 5. Music/Artist(s)
 6. Book(s)
 7. Movie(s)

Section B. Unofficial Transcript

All Prospective New Members must submit the following along with the application.

1. Unofficial Transcript

The most recent unofficial transcript must reflect a minimum term GPA of 2.3 and a cumulative GPA of 2.5, and confirm that the Prospective New Member is in good standing at the university where the chapter is established. Prospective New Members on academic probation, progress probation, or any other academic standing defined as probation by the university are not eligible to participate in the process. If the university where the chapter is established requires a higher minimum GPA, those minimum requirements must be met.

- a. The unofficial transcript must show registration as a full-time undergraduate or part-time graduate student.
- b. For transfer students, their transfer coursework and GPA must be included in calculating their cumulative GPA.
- c. Prospective New Members who are in their first term of college do not yet have a university grade point average, therefore are exempt to the GPA requirement until a GPA is established at their university.

Section C. Availability & Planning Form

The Pledge Mother(s) will share the availability and planning form via email with the Prospective New Member when notifying them of the interview. Each Prospective New Member must submit the availability and planning form that outlines the following:

1. Current Class Schedule: Include all enrolled courses with days, times, and course titles.
2. Key Academic Dates: List of major academic deadlines such as exams, midterms, project due dates, and finals for each course.
3. Work Schedule: If employed, include a current work schedule. If work hours are irregular or rotating, submit the schedule as far in advance as available at the time of application.
4. Additional Scheduling Conflicts: Include any known personal commitments, such as travel, family events, or religious observances that may affect availability during the Big Sister Little Sister process.

This document will first be used by the Pledge Mother(s) to schedule the Pinning Ceremony. Subsequently, it will assist in planning weekly meetings and ensuring that each Prospective New Member receives appropriate support for their academic and personal success throughout the Big Sister Little Sister process.

Section D. Interview

Interviews mark the end of the Rush period and serve as an opportunity for Active Members to assess whether Sigma Omega Nu is the right fit for each Prospective New Member. During the interview, Sisters will ask questions about the Prospective New Member's character, interests, values, and readiness to commit to a life of Sisterhood. Only those who complete the interview process will be considered eligible to receive a bid and advance to the Big Sister Little Sister process. A vote will be conducted by Active Members immediately following each interview to determine bid eligibility.

1. To be invited for an interview, a Prospective New Member must have attended at least one informational and one additional rush event, and submitted their Prospective New Member application and unofficial transcript.
2. The Pledge Mother(s) will notify eligible Prospective New Members via email, providing the date, time, and location of the interview. As well as the required attire (business casual), and a reminder to complete the availability and planning form (attached in the email for reference).
3. Interviews must be held on campus or at a location approved by the Chapter's Executive Board.
4. All Active Members of the Chapter are required to attend the interviews. Interviews may also be attended by any Sister who is in good standing with Sigma Omega Nu.
5. All Sigma Omega Nu Sisters present at the interviews are required to be dressed in business casual attire.

Section E. Interview Protocol

Each Prospective New Member will be interviewed individual by the Chapter. During the interview, each Active Member will take turns in asking a question. The interview will be evaluated using a standardized Interview Evaluation Rubric (refer to Appendix B), which includes: a set of recommended questions, the category and purpose of each question, a rating scale from 1 (Poor/No evidence) to 5 (Excellent/Exceeds expectations), and a section for additional comments.

All Active Members present are required to complete a separate evaluation rubric for each Prospective New Member, providing a rating for each response and including any relevant feedback or observations.

Section F. Interview Voting Procedure

Immediately following the interview for each Prospective New Member, the Active Members must engage in a brief discussion and vote on whether the individual should be invited to join the upcoming Pledge Class.

1. Prior to the vote:
 - a. Each Active Member who attended the interview must complete an Interview Evaluation Rubric based on the Prospective New Member's responses, professionalism, and perceived fit with Sigma Omega Nu's values.
 - b. The Pledge Committee will compile and summarize each Prospective New Member's application, transcript, and average rubric score for the Active Members.
2. Voting Process:
 - a. The vote must be conducted by the Chapter's Sergeant at Arms via a show of hands.
 - b. To receive a bid, a Prospective New Member must receive a simple majority (50%+1) vote from Active Members present.
 - c. The Chapter Sergeant at Arms must record and report the outcome of each vote to the Pledge Committee at the conclusion of all interviews.
 - d. Rubrics will be collected and reviewed by the Pledge Committee to ensure that decisions are made with objectivity and fairness, and to identify any discrepancies or concerns in the membership's assessments.
 - e. Rubric scores are not a replacement for voting but serve as a tool to guide thoughtful discussion and voting outcomes.

Section G. Legacy Consideration

A Legacy is defined as the legal sister, daughter or granddaughter of a Sister of Sigma Omega Nu. A prospective legacy is welcome and encouraged to participate in the Big Sister Little Sister Rush process. However, to ensure fairness and uphold the standards of Sigma Omega Nu, all legacies must meet all eligibility requirements and complete the full rush and interview process, including the submission of all required materials.

Legacy status does not guarantee a bid. Legacies will be evaluated using the same criteria, interview rubric, and voting process as all other Prospective New Members.

Article VIII. Bids & Pinning Ceremony

Section A. National Approval Requirement

1. Before delivering Bids, the Chapter must receive approval to begin the Big Sister Little Sister process. The following documents must be submitted using the method designated by the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs:

- a. Confirmation of a Clear Chapter Account Balance with the National Board; the National Vice President of Finance will provide confirmation directly to the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs
 - b. Signed Pledge Mother Contract(s)
 - c. Pledgeship Calendar of Events, including all assignments, activities, and ceremonies
 - d. New Pledge Class Induction Form
 - e. Unofficial Transcripts for all Prospective New Members
2. All required documents must be submitted to the Chapter's designated Regional Director at least two weeks before the scheduled Bid delivery.
 - a. The Regional Director will review all documents received. If all documents are complete and all Prospective New Members meet the minimum membership requirements, the Regional Director will then submit all documents directly to the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs for final approval.
 - b. If corrections are needed, or if any Prospective New Member does not meet the minimum membership requirements, the Regional Director will notify the Chapter with the revisions needed and/or the reasons why the Prospective New Member does not meet the minimum membership requirements.
 - c. The Chapter will have 7 days from the original submission date to resolve all outstanding issues.
 - d. If issues remain unresolved after the 7 days, the Chapter must postpone the delivery of bids.
 - e. Note: The Pledge Mother Contract(s) and Pledgeship Calendar of Events may be submitted as early as the first day of Rush. If submitted early, the remaining documents must still be submitted within the standard timeline described above.
3. Once the Regional Director submits the documents to the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs, a final review will be conducted within 7 days. Both the Regional Director and the Chapter will be notified of the decision.
 - a. If final approval is granted, the Chapter may proceed with delivering Bids.
 - b. If additional corrections are required, the Chapter must postpone Bid delivery until those issues are resolved.
4. Failure to Receive Approval
 - a. If the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs determines the Chapter proceeded with Pinning without approval as a result of a miscommunication between National Board and the Chapter, the Chapter will have one week to resolve all outstanding issues. The Chapter cannot proceed with any Pledgeship assignments designated for Week 2 or later until full approval is obtained.
 - b. If the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs determines the Chapter proceeded with Pinning without approval as a result of a willful and knowing defiance of these requirements and/or required the Little Sister to indicate they began Pledgeship at a date later than they actually did, the following actions will occur:
 1. The National Board will contact the Chapter to notify them that the Chapter has been suspended from pledging for the remainder of the

academic term. The National Board will also contact the Little Sisters directly to notify them that the Big Sister Little Sister process has been suspended and they are relieved of their duties immediately. The Chapter will otherwise be considered fully Active during this time. The Chapter will be permitted to pledge again during the following term, assuming all rules and regulations of Pledgeship are followed.

2. The Pledge Committee, including the Pledge Mothers and President, will be subject to a Judicial Review by the National Board for failure to fulfill the duties of their office and for violating Standardized Pledgeship guidelines.
3. If this violation occurs a second time within one calendar year, the Chapter will be placed on Suspension status. At that time, all Little Sisters will be immediately relieved of their obligations. The appropriate Greek council will also be notified.

Section B. Bid

The Sigma Omega Nu Bid serves as the official invitation to join the upcoming Pledge Class, with the goal of eventually becoming a Sister of Sigma Omega Nu.

1. Only Prospective New Members who have met all requirements outlined in Article VII Prospective New Members are eligible to receive a bid.
2. Bids must be presented to eligible Prospective New Members at least 72 hours prior to the Pinning Ceremony. Bids must be delivered by the Active Members of the Chapter. Any other Active Sister or Active Alumna who wishes to participate may do so, provided they notify the Pledge Mother(s) in advance of their intent to participate.
3. All participating Sisters must wear all black attire along with the Greek Letters of ΣΩΝ in the traditional colors, as agreed upon by the Chapter Membership. Acceptable examples include the crossing sweater or line jacket.
4. A single white rose must accompany each Bid and be presented to each eligible Prospective New Member.
5. Each Prospective New Member who receives a Bid will have a maximum of 48 hours to respond.
6. The Bid must consist of the following:

*The Sisters of Sigma Omega Nu, Latina Interest Sorority Inc.
Cordially invite you to participate in our (Term) (Year) Pledge Class.
The Pinning Ceremony for the (Letter) Pledge Class will take place on (Month) (Day), (Year)
Please meet at (Location) at (Time) promptly.
Please wear business casual attire.
You have 48 hours to confirm your presence to (Pledge Mother(s)) at (Phone Number)
MΣΨΛΣ*

Section C. Bid Considerations

1. Prior to extending Bids, Chapters are strongly encouraged to evaluate the number of eligible Prospective New Members in relation to the number of available Active Members eligible to serve as Big Sisters.
2. The Chapter should aim to ensure that there are sufficient Big Sisters to support meaningful Big/Little Sister pairings. If there are more Little Sisters than eligible Big

Sisters, a Big Sister may be assigned more than one personal Little Sister. Chapters should plan accordingly and communicate clearly with the membership regarding expectations.

Section D. Disclaimer Contract

1. The Disclaimer Contract is intended to inform Little Sisters of relevant organizational policies, including the Hazing Policy, and to provide clear information on whom they may contact if they have questions or are experience anything that may be considered hazing.
2. The contract must be signed prior to the Pinning Ceremony in order for a Prospective New Member to formally begin the Big Sister Little Sister process. Failure to submit a signed Disclaimer Contract will result in disqualification of the Bid, and the Prospective New Member will not be permitted to participate in the ceremony.
3. Upon acceptance of the Bid, the Pledge Mother(s) must email the Disclaimer Contract to each Prospective New Member for review and signature. The contract must be signed and returned before the scheduled Pinning Ceremony. The Pledge Mother(s) must also have printed copies available at the ceremony in case any Prospective New Member needs to sign in person.
4. The Pledge Mother(s) are responsible for collecting and securely retaining all signed Disclaimer Contracts, and must keep them readily available throughout the Big Sister Little Sister process.

Section E. Little Sister Pin

1. The Little Sister Pin will be a lapel pin of standard size and format. Little Sister Pins may be purchased from the National Board.
2. At the Pinning Ceremony, each Little Sister will receive a Little Sister Pin as a symbol of their entry into the Big Sister Little Sister process. Similar to the Sister pin worn by Active Members at weekly chapter meetings, Little Sisters are encouraged, but not required, to wear their Little Sister Pin to weekly meetings during the process.
3. If worn, the Little Sister Pin must be worn on the left side of the chest directly over the heart.

Section F. Ceremony

1. The Pinning Ceremony marks the official beginning of the Big Sister Little Sister process.
2. The Sigma Omega Nu Crest must be displayed the ceremony. The Pledge Mother(s) and Chapter President must stand in front of the Crest, and each hold a burgundy candle that is to remain lit during the ceremony. A pathway lined with lit candles must lead up to the Crest, where the Pledgeship oath will be read. It is strongly recommended that the Chapter President memorize the oath in advance of the Ceremony to ensure a meaningful and uninterrupted presentation.
3. The Pinning Ceremony is as follows:
 - a. The Prospective New Member is invited into the room.
 - b. The Prospective New Member is handed a white, unlit candle with the letters “SON” on it. The color of the letters and additional décor on the candle must be in one or more of the Official Colors.
 - c. The Prospective New Member walks down the pathway towards where the Chapter President and Pledge Mother(s) are standing. The Chapter President and Pledge Mother(s) will light the Prospective New Member’s candle.

- d. The Chapter President will then read the following oath for each Prospective New Member:

Chapter President: "We..."

All Sisters: "...Sigma Omega Nu"

Chapter President: "On this day (month/day/year), we Sigma Omega Nu,

Invite (Full Name) to be a Pledge Sister of the (Term and Year) Pledge Class.

Do you agree to keep all information concerning Sigma Omega Nu and _Pledge Class given to you confidential?"

[Wait for Prospective New Member's response]

Chapter President: "Do you accept?"

[Wait for Prospective New Member's response]

[Then have one of the Pledge Mothers put the Little Sister Pin on left side, over the heart]

Chapter President: "Please step in line"

[Once all Prospective New Members have been pinned, the Chapter President shall say]

Chapter President: "On the count of 3, please turn around and blow out your candles.

Section G. Ceremony Considerations

1. The Pinning Ceremony must be conducted with the utmost respect for the dignity, comfort, and safety of all participants.
2. Prospective New Members must be provided with appropriate waiting accommodations. These accommodations must include, at minimum: access to seating, access to a restroom, and access to their personal belongings, including cell phones.
3. Chapters must select a ceremony location that complies with all university policies. Whether held on or off campus, the location must be safe, respectful, inclusive, and approved (if required) through proper university event procedures. Chapters are responsible for verifying and adhering to all applicable university rules regarding venue usage and liability.
4. The location listed on the Bid must match the actual location of the ceremony. Chapters may not mislead or redirect Prospective New Members to a different, undisclosed venue.
5. If a Prospective New Member requires transportation, the Pledge Mother(s) may assist in coordinating transportation in a safe, approved, and transparent manner.
6. Blindfolding is strictly prohibited. No form of sensory deprivation, coercion, or symbolic control (including blindfolds, or similar materials) may be used during any part of the ceremony or its preparation.

Section H. Attire

1. All Sigma Omega Nu Sisters must wear all black business casual attire, including shoes. Shorts, black athletic shoes, and hats are not considered acceptable.
2. Absolutely no Greek letters are to be worn.
3. Prospective New Members must wear business casual attire. There are no specific colors requirements for their clothing.

Article IX. Minimum Pledgeship Requirements

Each Little Sister must meet and maintain all minimum membership requirements throughout the length of the Big Sister Little Sister process. Failure to maintain these requirements throughout the Big Sister Little Sister process will result in relief of duties and obligations as a Little Sister of Sigma Omega Nu.

Section A. Grade Point Average & Progress Reports

1. At the first official meeting with the Little Sisters, the Pledge Mother(s) must assign Progress Report forms for each class in which the Little Sister is enrolled. These forms must be completed and submitted to the Pledge Mother(s) no later than Week 3 or Week 4 of the process.
2. Each Progress Report form must be completed by the professor or instructor, indicating the Little Sister's current grade in the class.
3. Little Sisters are strongly encouraged to email their instructors and/or attend office hours to request completion of the progress report form. If a professor is unresponsive or does not hold office hours, the Little Sister may instead submit a screenshot of their course page (example, Canvas, or a comparable learning platform) that clearly shows their current grade.
4. Once all forms are submitted, the Pledge Mother(s) must forward the completed forms to the Chapter's Vice President, who will use the information provided to calculate the estimated term and cumulative GPA for each Little Sister.
 - a. If a Little Sister's calculated term GPA is below 2.3, and their cumulative GPA is below a 2.5, the Little Sister will be automatically relieved of their duties as a Little Sister of Sigma Omega Nu. This determination will be made by Week 3 or 4, based on submitted progress reports, to ensure the Little Sister has the necessary time and capacity to focus on improving their academic standing without the additional commitments of the Big Sister Little Sister process.
 - b. If a Little Sister's GPA is near the minimum threshold, the Pledge Mother(s), in collaboration with the Chapter's Vice President and with approval from the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs, may implement an academic improvement plan to support the Little Sister's academic success and continued participation.
5. The Chapter Vice President will scan and submit all Progress Reports plus the calculated grades to the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs by uploading into the appropriate Google Drive folder and will notify the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs once they have been submitted. These are to be submitted no later than the fifth week of the Big Sister Little Sister process.
6. It is the responsibility of the Pledge Mother(s) to verify that all Little Sisters have met the required GPA standards before recommending them for crossing.

Section B. Sober Pledgeship & Alcohol/Drug Policy

1. All Little Sisters under the age of 21 are required to maintain a sober pledgeship throughout the entire Big Sister Little Sister process, in accordance with federal and state laws regarding the legal drinking age. This means that Little Sisters under the age of 21 are strictly

prohibited from consuming alcoholic beverages or using illegal drugs that are not prescribed by a licensed medical professional.

2. Little Sisters who are 21 or older are likewise prohibited from using illegal drugs that are not prescribed by a licensed medical professional. While those 21 and older may legally consume alcohol outside of sorority obligations, they are encouraged to maintain a commitment to sobriety throughout the process in support of a respectful pledgeship experience.
3. To uphold a respectful and responsibility environment, Little Sisters are expected to be fully sober for at least four (4) hours prior to any meeting, event or activity, including but not limited to study hours, fundraisers, and community service events. This ensures that all participants can engage with clarity, focus, and mutual respect. This standard is similar to what would be expected in a professional or academic setting, just as one would not attend a class or workplace obligation while under the influence, the same applies to the process.
 - a. If a Little Sister arrives at a meeting, event or activity and is noticeably impaired due to alcohol or drug use, the Pledge Mother(s) reserve the right to ask the Little Sister to leave immediately. This action will be taken in the interest of safety, maintain the integrity of the process, and upholding the standards of Sigma Omega Nu.
 - b. The Pledge Mother(s) is to document the incident and bring to the attention of the Pledge Committee for formal review. A unanimous vote by the Pledge Committee confirming a violation will result in the Little Sister being relieved of their duties and removed from the process.
4. Use of prescription medication, as directed by a licensed medical provider, and over-the-counter medications, taken according to labeled dosing instructions, is permitted.
5. While Little Sisters are not prohibited from being in environments where alcohol or drugs may be present, they are expected to demonstrate sound judgement.
6. If credible, concrete evidence is presented to the Pledge Committee indicating that a Little Sister has violated this policy, the Pledge Committee will review and deliberate on the evidence. A unanimous vote by the Pledge Committee confirming a violation will result in the Little Sister being relieved of their duties and removed from the Big Sister Little Sister process.

Section C. Little Sister Pin

At the Pinning Ceremony, each Little Sister will receive a Little Sister Pin as a symbol of their entry into the Big Sister Little Sister process. Similar to the Sister Pin worn by Active Members at weekly chapter meetings, Little Sisters are encouraged, but not required, to wear their Little Sister Pin to weekly meetings during the process. At the Crossover Ceremony, each Little Sister will be presented with the Sister Pin. The Sister pin serves as a symbol of their formal initiation and lifelong commitment to the sisterhood.

Section D. Attendance

1. Little Sisters are allowed a maximum of three (3) unexcused absences from meetings or activities throughout the Big Sister Little Sister process.
 - a. Meetings are defined as the weekly meetings at which the Pledge Mother(s) are present. Meetings held among the Pledge Class for the purpose of additional planning or coordination do not count toward this requirement.

- b. Activities include the Candlelight Ceremony, Big Sister Little Sister Potluck, Group Community Service Event and Exit Interviews.
2. To request an excused absence, the Little Sister must submit a written letter to the Pledge Mother(s) at least 24 hours in advance to the event. The letter will be read aloud at the next meeting with the Pledge Mother(s), and the Pledge Class will vote to approve or deny the request. A majority vote is required to excuse the absence.
 - a. If the letter is not approved or not submitted on time, the absence will be considered unexcused.
 - b. Upon a fourth unexcused absence, the Little Sister will be automatically relieved of their duties and removed from the process.
 - c. If a fourth absence is declared unexcused, the Little Sister will automatically be relieved of her duties as a Little Sister for Sigma Omega Nu.
 - d. Spending time with a Personal Big Sister is not considered an acceptable excuse, nor can a Big Sister relieve a Little Sister of obligatory attendance at an event previously scheduled by the Pledge Mother(s).
3. In the event of an emergency, the Little Sister must notify the Pledge Mother(s) as soon as possible. A written letter explaining the situation must be submitted within seven days of the absence for consideration.
 - a. If the emergency absence would be the fourth unexcused absence, the Little Sister must not be automatically relieved of their duties until the full seven-day period has passed and the absence is formally voted on.

Section E. Use of Greek Letters and Organizational Representation

1. Little Sisters are not allowed to wear the Greek Letters of Sigma Omega Nu ($\Sigma\Omega N$) together in that order, as doing so signifies full membership in the organization. Wearing the Greek Letters represents a formal connection to our sisterhood, commitment to its mission, and adherence to the standards expected of initiated members. As such, only fully initiated members may wear or use the Greek Letters $\Sigma\Omega N$ to identify themselves with the organization.
2. Little Sisters may wear paraphernalia that has Sigma Omega Nu written out or abbreviated as S.O.N., as long as the item also clearly includes identifying terms such as “Little Sister” or “Pledge Class” adjacent to the name. This ensures clarity that the wearer is a Prospective New Member currently in the Big Sister Little Sister process.
3. Little Sisters may not write or use the Official Greek Letters of $\Sigma\Omega N$ on any personal items, such as binders, clothing, or social media, unless specifically instructed to do so by the Pledge Mother(s).
4. Active Members may not include the Official Greek Letters $\Sigma\Omega N$ on any gifts, crafts, or projects intended for Little Sisters. This policy preserves the symbolic significant of the Greek Letters and ensures they are reserved for fully initiated members.

Section F. Binder

Each Little Sister will be issued a binder, which must be brought to every meeting and kept confidential. The binder must be a black, three-ring binder, include a clear plastic cover pocket, and be no larger than one-inch. The cover sheet must be inserted into the front pocket and include the following text:

Sigma Omega Nu Latina Interest Sorority, Inc.
Pledge Class (Term) (Year)

The binder will contain all materials and information provided by the Pledge Mother(s). The binder and its contents are confidential and are not to be shared or shown to anyone outside of Sigma Omega Nu. When not in use, it should be stored in a secure location where non-members cannot access it. If a Little Sister is removed from the Big Sister Little Sister process or chooses to withdraw voluntarily, the binder must be returned immediately to the Pledge Mother(s).

Section G. Community Service

All Little Sisters are required to complete a minimum of 5 hours of community service by the conclusion of the Big Sister Little Sister process.

1. It is the responsibility of each Little Sister, in coordination with the Pledge Class, to identify one or more community service projects or events. These must be submitted to the Pledge Mother(s) for approval to ensure the project/event is beneficial to the community.
2. Preference may be given to service opportunities that align with the Chapter's Philanthropy.
3. Of the required 5 hours, at least 2 hours must be complete collectively as a Pledge Class at a single event or through a coordinated service project.
4. Community Service hours must be documented using the Community Service Form.

Section H. Study Hours

To support academic success during the Big Sister Little Sister process, each Little Sister is required to complete a minimum of four study hours per week.

1. Study hours must be completed in groups of at least two Little Sisters to encourage peer support and accountability.
2. Study hours may take place on campus (for example, university library, study lounges, etc.), or at a pre-approved off-campus location such as a public library, cofree shop, or another designated study-friendly environment.
3. These hours are to be used exclusively for academic coursework, including reading, assignments, studying for exams, and group class projects. Pledgeship assignments may not be completed during this time.
4. Little Sisters must notify Pledge Mother(s) of their planned study hour schedule by Sunday night each week. This allows the Pledge Mother(s) to share the schedule with Active Members who may wish to join and provide academic or moral support.
 - a. If any changes to the schedule occur during the week the Little Sister(s) must inform the Pledge Mother(s) so that the updated schedule can be communicated to Active Members.

5. The Pledge Class Vice President is responsible for tracking a weekly log of study hours. This log must include the date, location, and participating Little Sisters. The logs must be submitted to the Pledge Mother(s) at the end of each week.

Section I. Dues

Each Little Sister is required to pay dues in the amount of \$150. This amount is non-refundable and must be paid in full by the seventh week of the Big Sister Little Sister process. If needed, payment plans may be arranged through the Chapter Treasurer.

1. Collection and Financial Oversight
 - a. All dues will be collected by the Pledge Mother(s) and submitted directly to the Chapter Treasurer to ensure proper financial tracking and documentation. The Chapter Treasurer is responsible for maintain accurate records of all pledgeship related transactions and ensuring that all spending aligns with the approved pledgeship budget.
2. Use of Dues
 - a. Dues must be used to cover all materials and supplies necessary for the Big Sister Little Sister process, as outlined in the schedule, with the exception of expenses related to Bids and Pinning Ceremony.
 - b. Prior to the Pinning Ceremony, the Pledge Mother(s) must submit a tentative pledgeship budget to the Chapter Treasurer. This budget must include all anticipated expenses associated with the Big Sister Little Sister process, excluding bids and the pinning ceremony.
 - c. Dues may be used to cover the cost of official transcripts, if this expense is listed in the approved pledgeship budget.
 - d. Any additional items not included in the schedule may be purchased using remaining due funds, only if sufficient funds are available.
3. Bids and Pinning Expenses
 - a. Expenses related to bids and the pinning ceremony must be submitted under a separate budget, to be funded and/or reimbursed by the Chapter. This budget must also be submitted to the Chapter Treasurer.

Article X. Journal

Section A. Size

At the first meeting, each Little Sister must receive a journal. The journal must be a standard composition notebook, not exceeding 10.25 inches by 8 inches in size.

Section B. Requirements

1. Decoration: Each Little Sister will have one week from the day they receive the journal to decorate it. The journal must be fully covered; the Little Sister's name must be clearly displayed on the front. Decoration is intended to reflect each individual's personality and creativity; all other design elements are left to the discretion of the Little Sister.
2. Usage & Confidentiality: Journals must be brought to all meetings. Journals are for the exclusive use of the Big Sister Little Sister process and are not to be used for personal purposes. The contents of the journal are confidential and must not be shared with anyone outside of Sigma Omega Nu.

Section C. Purpose

1. Weekly Reflections: Throughout the Big Sister Little Sister process, the Pledge Mother(s) will assign weekly writing prompts for the entire pledge class.
 - a. Little Sisters must respond to each prompt in their journals.
 - b. The journal is a confidential space intended for Little Sisters to reflect honestly on their experience without fear or judgement or repercussions.
 - c. Only the Pledge Committee may read the journal responses during meetings and are encouraged to reply with supportive and uplifting comments.
2. Feedback Tool: Journals may be used as a way for the Pledge Mother(s) to gain insight into the Big Sister Little Sister process and identify areas for improvement, ensuring the experience remains meaningful and supportive.
3. Additional Assignments: The journal may also be used for other sorority assignments, such as interviews, family trees, and additional written tasks assigned by the Pledge Mother(s).

Article XI. Pledge Class Officers

Section A. Purpose

The purpose of pledge class officers is to provide structure, leadership, and accountability within the pledge class throughout the Big Sister Little Sister process. These positions offer an opportunity for early leadership development and serves as a foundation for understanding the expectations of full membership in Sigma Omega Nu.

Holding a pledge class position provides insight into the responsibilities of an active sister, who must regularly balance academic success, chapter meetings, and leadership roles, alongside school, work, and personal life. Through these officer positions, Little Sisters begin to practice time management, communication, and multitasking in a supportive environment.

Pledge Mother(s), along with Active Members, will provide guidance and mentorship throughout the process to help each officer learn how to manage these demands in a healthy and sustainable way.

Section B. Election

The Pledge Class must elect officers to serve for the duration of the process. Elections must be conducted by secret ballot to ensure fairness and confidentiality. If there are more Little Sisters than available officer positions, co-chairs arrangements may be permitted for any office except President. To provide additional opportunities for involvement, elected officers may form committees to assist with their responsibilities and allow other Little Sisters to participate in the planning and execution of pledge class requirements.

All officer roles must be clearly defined, and written descriptions of each position must be provided to the pledge class prior to elections.

Section C. Modifications Due to Class Size

In the event that the Pledge class does not have enough Little Sisters to fill all officer positions:

1. The Pledge Mother(s) and Pledge Committee may:
 - a. Consolidate compatible positions, assigning multiple responsibilities to a single officer when feasible. For example, combining Vice President and

- Communications Chair, Treasurer and Fundraising Chair, and Sergeant at Arms and Service/Sisterhood Chair.
 - b. Reclassify certain positions as committees under existing officers to reduce the total number of formal positions while still allowing participation. For example, Community Service Committee, Fundraising Committee, etc.
 - c. Prioritize essential positions, such as President, Vice President, Treasurer, and Communications Officer, while assigning others as optional.
2. If the Pledge Class consists of only one Little Sister, officer elections will not be held. Instead, the Pledge Mother(s) will work directly with the Little Sister to provide leadership development opportunities in place of traditional officer responsibilities.
 - a. The Little Sister may be offered the chance to shadow Chapter officers to simulate the officer experience in a personalized format. The experience should focus on mentorship, time management, and organizational awareness, aligning with the intent of the officer structure, even if formal roles are not assigned.
 3. All adjustments made must be documented by the Pledge Mother(s) and shared with the Chapter for transparency.

Section D. Officers

The following offices must be held by the Little Sisters of the Pledge Class for the duration of the Big Sister Little Sister process:

1. President

The President will lead all Pledge Class meetings and events not directed by the Pledge Mother(s). They are responsible for:

- a. Providing guidance to the Pledge Class and its officers
- b. As required by the university, coordinating with the appropriate Chapter officer, to make room reservations for meetings and activities
- c. Assigning an acting Communications Officer in the event of an absence
- d. Reporting to the Pledge Mother(s) on matters affecting the Pledge Class

2. Vice President

The Vice President will act in place of the President during their absence. They are also responsible for:

- a. Organizing weekly study sessions
- b. Coordinating academic or professional workshops for the pledge class
- c. Recognizing Pledge Sisters for academic excellence
- d. Ensuring all progress reports are completed and submitted on time

3. Communications Officer

The Communications Officer is responsible for managing meeting communication and records. They are responsible for:

- a. Collecting agenda items from officers and working with the Pledge Mother(s) to finalize the pledge meeting agendas
- b. Distributing the agenda before each meeting and the minutes afterward
- c. Taking accurate minutes of all meetings and submitting them to the Pledge Mother(s) within three days

- d. Maintaining organized records of all minutes and making them accessible to Pledge Mother(s) and Little Sisters
- e. Notifying all Little Sisters and Pledge Mother(s) of upcoming meetings and activities

4. Treasurer

Alongside the Chapter's Treasurer, the Pledge Class Treasurer will help manage all financial matters related to the Pledge Class, They are responsible for:

- a. Maintaining accurate records of all revenue and expenses
- b. Collecting and reviewing all tentative and final budgets, before submitting to the Pledge Mother(s) and Chapter Treasurer
- c. Ensuring Little Sisters maintain valid receipts for all pre-approved purchases

5. Sergeant at Arms

The Sergeant at Arms will maintain order and ensure structure during meetings. They are responsible for:

- a. Keeping all meetings (with and without the Pledge Mother(s)) to one hour unless extended by a majority vote.
- b. Ensuring the agenda is followed and discussions remain on topic.
- c. Tracking attendance, tardiness, and submitted letters of excuse.

6. Community Service Chair

The Community Service Chair will coordinate service initiatives for the Pledge Class. They are responsible for:

- a. Informing Pledge Sisters of upcoming service opportunities
- b. Selecting one mandatory service project, aligned with the Chapter's philanthropy
- c. Tracking and reporting service hours completed by each Little Sister to the Pledge Mother(s)

7. Fundraising Chair

The Fundraising Chair will oversee all fundraising efforts. They are responsible for:

- a. Coordinating fundraisers to meet the Pledge Class goals
- b. Distributing and collecting tickets or materials (if applicable)
- c. Preparing a financial report (noting the revenues and expenses, and profit/loss) for each fundraiser to be presented at the following Pledge Class meeting.
- d. Submitting all funds raised to Chapter Treasurer.

8. Social Chair

The Social Chair will plan and coordinate all non-sisterhood social events during the Big Sister Little Sister process. They are responsible for:

- a. Lead the Little Sister Committee for the Big Sister Little Sister Potluck
- b. Serving as the primary liaison between the Pledge Class and other organizations for social events.
- c. Maintaining a calendar of all Pledge Class events
- d. Ensuring all events comply with Sigma Omega Nu and university policies

9. Publicity Chair

The Publicity Chair will manage marketing and promotion for the Pledge Class. They are responsible for:

- a. Designing flyers and digital materials for fundraisers, service projects, and announcements.
- b. Coordinating with the Chapter Commissioner of Public Relations to promote fundraisers via the Chapter's social media.
- c. Highlighting Little Sister achievements in academics, cultura, community service, and leadership during pledge class meetings.
- d. Taking pictures at all events, unless asked not to.
- e. Overseeing the ordering of Pledge Class t-shirts

10. Cultura & Sisterhood Chair

The Cultura & Sisterhood Chair will promote cultural awareness and strengthen internal sisterhood. They are responsible for:

- a. Identifying and organizing at least one cultural event that encourages appreciation of diversity within the Pledge Class.
- b. Coordinating or identifying substance abuse and sexual assault awareness training for the Pledge Class (unless already provided by the university of Greek Council)
- c. Planning informal sisterhood activities during pledge class meetings or work sessions to encourage bonding. Examples include, a playlist of each Little Sister's favorite songs, a mini potluck, Pledge Sister trivia, other low effort but meaningful team-building activities.

Article XII. Pledge Class Meetings

Section A. Purpose

The purpose of the pledge class meetings is to facilitate communication, education, planning, and progress throughout the Big Sister Little Sister process. Meetings are designed to provide structured time for completing assignments, reviewing expectations, engaging in educational development, and strengthening the unity of the pledge class. These meetings also prepare Little Sisters for the structure, responsibilities, and culture of future chapter meetings as Active Members.

Section B. Frequency and Required Attendance

1. The Pledge Mother(s) are to arrange a weekly meeting with the Pledge Class, to be held on campus at a time and location approved by the university.
2. Meetings may not begin before 8:00am or end after 10:00pm, to respect academic and personal obligations.
3. All meetings must follow the Sigma Omega Nu General Meeting format. The Pledge Mother(s) will provide the Pledge Class Communications Officer with the agenda at least 24 hours prior to the meeting. The Communications Officer will distribute the agenda to the Pledge Class prior to the Pledge class meeting. The Communications Officer is responsible for distributing the meeting minutes to the Pledge Class and Pledge Mother(s) no later than three days following the meeting.

4. All members of the Pledge Committee are required to attend these meetings.
5. Active Chapter Sisters are encouraged, but not required, to attend.
6. Non-Active Members in good standing may attend meetings if permitted by their membership status, but they must receive prior approval from the Pledge Mother(s) and notify them at least 24 hours in advance.
7. Sisters must not contradict or override the authority of the Pledge Mother(s) in front of the Little Sisters. Any concerns, disagreements, or questions about the Big Sister Little Sister process or assignments should be addressed privately with the Pledge Mother(s) or raised during the next Chapter meeting. However, respectful interruptions may be made if: a sister is correcting a factual inaccuracy, such as the misquoting of chapter bylaws or university policy; or an action, instruction, or interaction may reasonably be perceived as hazing or otherwise violate standardized pledgeship or university policies. In such cases, corrections or concerns should be voiced calmly, professionally, and with the intention of upholding accuracy, transparency, and member safety.
8. The Pledge Class may schedule and hold additional meetings amongst themselves to further plan and coordinate themselves. These meetings must follow the same structure: minutes must be recorded and submitted to the Pledge Mother(s) within three days.

Section C. Officer Reports

Prior to each meeting, the Pledge Mother(s) will request each Pledge Class Officer to submit discussion topics related to their responsibilities for inclusion in the agenda. During the meeting, officers are expected to present a brief oral report summarizing their updates, progress, or issues.

Section D. Structure

Each meeting will begin with a relevant educational lesson facilitated by the Pledge Mother(s). Topics may include Sigma Omega Nu's history, objectives, or other subjects important to the development of Prospective New Members. Pledge Mother(s) must invite Chapter Officers to give presentations on their roles and responsibilities. These presentations are intended to illustrate the function and significance of leadership positions at the chapter level and to inspire involvement. Educational content and officer presentations will serve as context for assignments that are introduced or distributed during the meeting. Assignments will align with the weekly lesson and reinforce key learning objectives.

Each meeting will also include Officer Reports from the Pledge Class. Pledge Class Officers are responsible for giving updates on their position, progress, and any relevant concerns. This practice promotes leadership development, accountability, and internal communication within the Pledge Class.

Time must be allotted during each meeting for written and/or oral quizzes. Please refer to Article XIII (Quizzes) for more details.

Section E. Assignments

1. The Pledge Mother(s) will issue assignments throughout the Big Sister Little Sister process. The minimum required assignments are listed in Appendix A. Assignments may be adjusted to accommodate academic calendars and Chapter events, but may not be scheduled more than one week before or after their designated timeframe.
2. The Pledge Mother(s) are responsible for tracking assignment submissions. Each assignment must be documented in the meeting minutes with its status: submitted on time

and complete, submitted late, incomplete, or granted an extension with a new due date. The Chapter Sergeant at Arms will verify completion and accuracy of all assignments and reporting. Any discrepancies must be reported to the Chapter's Executive Board.

3. For each assignment, the Pledge Mother(s) must clearly communicate the purpose and objective, verbally and in writing, at the time of assignment. Objectives must align with one or more of Sigma Omega Nu's three official objectives, and/or include: Sorority Operations, Professionalism, Event Planning, or Budgeting.
4. Only assignments listed in Appendix A may be assigned. No additional or unofficial assignments may be issued.

Article XIII. Quizzes

Section A. Purpose

The purpose of quizzes is to support learning, reinforcing key knowledge about Sigma Omega Nu and Chapter history, and promote accountability in a respectful, non-punitive manner.

Section B. Quiz Format & Testable Knowledge

Written and/or oral quizzes on Sigma Omega Nu knowledge may be administered at Pledge class meetings. The Pledge Mother(s) will provide advance notice of the material to be tested at the following meeting. Only information assigned by the Pledge Mother(s) is to be considered testable information. Reasonable accommodations, such as extended time, separate space, etc. will be provided upon request.

Quiz formats may include:

- a. Memory Recall quizzes may be used for the Greek Alphabet, Founding Mothers, Chapter Founding Sisters, Sorority Establishment Date, Chapter Establishment Date, Objectives, Colors, Flowers, Symbol, Nicknames, Founders Quote, and the Crest.
- b. Multiple Choice or Fill in the Blank quizzes may be used for the Founding Chapter History and Chapter History.
- c. Written quizzes may increase in level of difficulty as the process progresses.

Section C. Written Quizzes

Written quizzes may be administered during the designated portion of the pledge class meeting. The Pledge Mother(s) are responsible for preparing the quiz, communicating expectations, and ensuring testing occurs in a quiet and focused environment.

Section D. Oral Quizzes

Oral quizzes are permitted if all of the following requirements are met:

1. Administration Format
 - a. Quizzes must be conducted one-on-one, between one Little Sister and one Active Sister.
 - b. Group quizzes are strictly prohibited. The Pledge Class may not be lined up, stood in formation, or directed to recite information as group, in unison, or in a repetitive

manner. These practices are considered hazing behaviors and are not allowed under any circumstance.

2. Timing & Location

- a. Quizzes must take place on-campus, either immediately before or during the scheduled pledge class meeting.
- b. The Pledge Mother(s) are responsible for allotting dedicated time during the meeting for each Little Sister to complete their quiz.
- c. Alternatively, Pledge Mother(s) may allow Little Sisters to arrive early to complete their quiz prior to the start of the meeting, provided it is done in a quiet, supervised environment.
- d. Quizzes may not be held off-campus or on days outside the regular meeting schedule.

3. Who May Conduct Oral Quizzes

- a. Only Pledge Mother(s) and members of the Pledge Committee may conduct oral quizzes by default.
- b. If the Pledge Committee will not be present or additional support is needed due to the pledge class size, Active Members may assist with oral quizzes.
- c. All sisters (pledge mothers, pledge committee and active members) must have passed both a written and oral quiz administered by the Chapter Sergeant at Arms with a minimum score of 80%. The test must cover all testable material for Little Sisters. Sisters may not choose which material that are tested on.

4. Testing Material

- a. The Pledge Mother(s) will provide a printed sheet of the designated testable material for those conducting oral quizzes.
- b. Sisters conducting the quiz must mark any material missed and submit the completed quiz sheet to the Pledge Mother(s) for review.
- c. There will be no consequences or punishments for incorrect answers, or difficulty recalling information.
- d. If a Little Sister struggles during the quiz, they may pause and restart as needed.

5. Professional Conduct

- a. Quizzes are considered educational components of the process. All participating sisters must conduct themselves in a professional manner at all times.
- b. The following are strictly prohibited during oral quizzes: laughing, foul language, making phone calls or texting, displaying frustration or making disrespectful remarks (for example, disappointment, sarcasm, or belittling comments).
- c. Any sister who engages in inappropriate conduct during a quiz will be prohibited from conducting any further quizzes with the current pledge class.

Section E. Practice Informationals

In place of written and oral quizzes toward the end of the process, Little Sisters may complete Practice Informationals as a cumulative assignment to demonstrate their knowledge of Sigma Omega Nu and develop public speaking skills.

1. Purpose: This alternative is designed to reinforce the Little Sisters' understanding of Sigma Omega Nu's history, purpose, and values; develop public speaking and presentation skills;

prepare Little Sisters to lead rush informationals and represent the sorority confidently in future recruitment efforts.

2. Format and Expectations: The Pledge Class will prepare and deliver a formal presentation that includes the following:
 - a. A slideshow or visual component (PPT, Google Slides)
 - b. Professional dress attire at the time of presentation
 - c. Content prepared and presented individually
 - d. A focus on the history, values, and identity of Sigma Omega Nu

The presentation should mirror the structure and professional expected during official chapter informationals, particularly those held during Rush. The Pledge Mother(s) will share with the Pledge Class a copy of the chapter's presentation for reference.

3. Scheduling
 - a. Practice informationals will be scheduled by the Pledge Mother(s) and conducted during pledge class meetings towards the end of the process to replace written and oral quizzes.
4. Evaluation
 - a. Pledge Mother(s), and optionally members of the Pledge Committee, may observe the presentations and provide constructive feedback. Presentations are not graded but are required for completion of the process.

Article XIV. Knowledge Requirements and Final Interview

Section A. Required Knowledge

1. At the conclusion of the process, each Little Sister must be capable of identifying the following:
 - a. Greek Alphabet
 - b. Founding Mothers Scrolls
 - c. Sorority Establishment Date
 - d. Chapter Founding Sisters Scrolls
 - e. Chapter Establishment Date
 - f. Objectives
 - g. Symbol
 - h. Colors
 - i. Flowers
 - j. Sorority Nicknames
 - k. Founders Quote

Section B. Progress Interviews

1. Prior to being granted membership into Sigma Omega Nu, each Little Sister must participate in an interview conducted by the Chapter's Active Members. To maintain confidentiality, these interviews will be referred to as Progress Interviews.
2. The purpose of the Progress Interview is to assess the Little Sister's growth throughout the pledgship process, provide constructive feedback, and ensure they have demonstrated an understanding of the organization's values, expectations, and responsibilities.

3. Progress interviews must take place no earlier than one week prior to the proposed crossover date. The Pledge Mother(s) will determine and communicate the specific date, time and location of the interviews.
4. If a Little Sister is unable to attend the scheduled Progress Interview, they must submit a Letter of Excuse. In such cases, the Pledge Mother(s) will arrange for them to participate via phone or Zoom at the designed time. If remote participation is also not possible, the Pledge Mother(s) may request approval from the Active Members to reschedule the interview for an alternative date.
5. Failure to attend the Progress Interview without an approved excuse will result in the Little Sister being automatically relieved of their duties and status as a Little Sister.
6. Each Little Sister will be interviewed individually by the Chapter. During the interview, each Active Member will take turns in asking a question. The interview will be evaluated using a standardized Interview Evaluation Rubric, which includes: a set of recommended questions, the category and purpose of each question, a rating scale from 1 (Poor/No Evidence) to 5 (Excellent/Exceeds Expectations), and a section for additional comments.
7. All Active Members present are required to complete a separate evaluation rubric for each Little Sister, providing a rating for each response and including any relevant feedback or observations. The completed rubrics will be collected and reviewed by the Pledge Committee to identify strengths, areas for continued development, and any recurring concerns. The Pledge Committee may also review rubric trends to ensure evaluations are fair, consistent, and free from bias.
8. Following each Progress Interview, the Chapter may engage in a brief discussion focused on providing constructive feedback and identifying any significant concerns related to the Little Sister's completion of the pledgeship process. This discussion is intended to support consistency and transparency and shall not include a membership vote.
9. If the Progress Interview or collected evaluations reveal credible concerns that a Little Sister has committed a violation of the Standardized Pledgeship or has failed to complete pledgeship requirements, the Pledge Committee shall review the concerns and consult with the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs before any decision regarding the Little Sister's crossover or membership status is made. Any recommendation to deny crossover must be based on documented violations or unmet requirements, not on subjective opinion or popularity. Following consultation with the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs, any necessary actions shall be taken in accordance with Standardized Pledgeship.

Article XV. Crossover Ceremony

Section A. National Approval Requirement

1. The Chapter must receive approval to cross a Pledge Class. The following documents must be submitted using the method designated by the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs:
 - a. Confirmation of a Clear Chapter Account Balance with the National Board; the National Vice President of Finance will provide confirmation directly to the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs.
 - b. New Member Initiation Form

- c. Progress Reports for all Little Sisters
 - d. Official Transcripts for all Little Sisters
 - e. Reading of the Banner Test passed by the Chapter President and Pledge Mother(s); the National Vice President of Parliament will provide confirmation directly to the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs.
- 2. All required documents must be submitted to the Chapter's designated Regional Director at least two weeks before the scheduled Crossover ceremony.
 - a. The Regional Director will review all documents received. If all documents are complete and all the Little Sisters meet the minimum membership requirements, the Regional Director will then submit all documents directly to the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs for final approval.
 - b. If corrections are needed, or if any Little Sister does not meet the minimum membership requirements, the Regional Director will notify the Pledge Mother(s) with the revisions needed and/or the reasons why the Little Sister does not meet the minimum membership requirements.
 - c. The Pledge Mother(s) will have 7 days from the original submission date to resolve all outstanding issues.
 - d. If issues remain unresolved after the 7 days, the Pledge Mother(s) must postpone the crossover ceremony.
 - e. If not submitted at least two weeks prior to the scheduled Crossover Ceremony, the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs may require that the Little Sisters be removed from the process.
- 3. Once the Regional Director submits the documents to the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs, a final review will be conducted within 7 days. Both the Regional Director and the Pledge Mother(s) will be notified of the decision.
 - a. If final approval is granted, the Chapter may proceed with the crossover ceremony.
 - b. If additional corrections are required, the Chapter must postpone the crossover ceremony until those issues are resolved.
- 4. Once the Chapter has been approved to proceed with Crossover, the Pledge Mother(s) can request the current Nickname List from the National Vice President of Communications.
- 5. Failure to Receive Approval
 - a. If the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs determines the Chapter proceeded with Crossover without approval as a result of a miscommunication between National Board and the Chapter, the Chapter will have one week to resolve all outstanding issues. During this time, the nicknames for the New Members will not be accepted. Once all outstanding issues have been resolved, the National Vice President of Communications will accept the Chapter's nicknames. The nicknames will then be evaluated for any repeats of nicknames that were accepted during the time it took for the Chapter to resolve the outstanding issues.
 - b. If the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs determines the Chapter proceeded with Crossover without approval as a result of a willful and knowing

defiance of these requirements and/or required the Little sisters to indicate they crossed on a date later than they actually did, the following actions will occur:

- a. The Chapter will be immediately placed on Suspension status and will remain on Suspension status for the entire following academic year. The appropriate Greek Council will be notified.
- b. The Pledge Committee, including the Pledge Mothers and Chapter President, and any other Sisters determined to have actively participated in these actions, will be subject to a Judicial Review by the National Board for failure to fulfill the duties of their office and for violating Standardized Pledgeship guidelines.
- c. The nicknames of the New Members will not be accepted until the end of the current academic term at which time they will be evaluated for any repeats of nicknames that were accepted throughout the term.

Section B. Date Setting

1. The Pledge Mother(s) must present the Pledgeship Calendar of Events, which was submitted to the National Board prior to the Pinning Ceremony, to the Chapter during the first general meeting following pinning. At this meeting, the Pledge Mother(s) must propose a tentative Crossover Ceremony date based on the calendar and the projected timeline of the process. The tentative date must be approved by the majority vote of Active Members during this meeting.
2. The final date, location and venue of the Crossover Ceremony must be confirmed and approved by the Active Members no later than the sixth week of the process.
3. The Crossover date and location must also be communicated to National Board on the New Member Initiation Form.
4. If attending another Chapter's Crossover Ceremony, Chapters and National Board must RSVP with the Chapter's President and one Chapter Pledge Mother via email at minimum one week prior to the scheduled date.
5. Only Sisters and Chapters in Good Standing are allowed to attend Crossover Ceremonies. The Chapter's Sergeant at Arms must verify those in attendance, both Chapter and Non-Chapter Sisters, are in Good Standing.
6. If unforeseen circumstances prevent the Little Sisters from crossing on the approved date, the Chapter must set a new Crossover date and provide notice to all Active Members within 48 hours. In addition, the Pledge Mother(s) must notify the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs immediately with the revised date and reason for the change.

Section C. Reading of the Banner

1. As soon as a Pledge Class has been pinned, the Pledge Mother(s) and Chapter President may schedule a meeting with the National Vice President of Parliament to be tested on their ability to correctly present the Reading of the Banner to the Little Sisters. The Pledge Mother(s) and the Chapter President will also be tested on the meanings and symbols.
2. The Pledge Mother(s) must coordinate a date and time when both the Pledge Mother(s) and the Chapter President are available to participate in the test.

3. The test must be passed at least two weeks prior to the scheduled Crossover date.
4. If the Pledge Mother(s) and Chapter President do not pass the test on the first attempt, a re-test will need to be scheduled. Rescheduling will be at the discretion of the National Vice President of Parliament's availability. In this case, the Reading of the Banner with the Pledge Class must be postponed until the re-test is passed.
5. The Reading of the Banner with the Pledge Class must take place in conjunction with and immediately following the revealing of the meanings and symbols. At minimum, all Little Sisters should be able to read the Banner from top to bottom.

Note: The Banner is the actual physical object, the Crest is the entire image, and the Scroll is the single object within the Crest.

6. How to Officially Read the Crest (top to bottom):
 - a. The Greek Letters ΣΩΝ are at the top, which is the sorority name. ΣΩΝ stands for _____.
 - b. Chapter Banner: Under ΣΩΝ is "Founding Chapter, Established 1996, Cal Poly San Luis Obispo."
 - c. Inside the scroll, in the top left corner in the pyramid, which represents Cultura.
 - d. Below that is La Mujer, which represent Cultura and the Indigenous Roots of the Sisters.
 - e. La Mujer is holding the Lamp of Knowledge, which represents Academics. Coming from the Lamp of Knowledge is the Book of Knowledge which contains the names of the eight Founding Mothers in no particular order. This represents Sisterhood and Academics.
 - f. From the book comes the Sun, Sigma Omega Nu's symbol, which stands for _____.
 - g. At the bottom of the scroll are the 3 objectives, Academics, Cultura, and Sisterhood.
 - h. Below the scroll are the branches of Laurel Leaves, which represent the Binding of Sisterhood. In the Laurel Leaves are 8 individual candles, each representing one of the 8 individual Founding Mother Mothers, but they are still bound together by the Laurel Leaves.
 - i. Below that is the sorority name spelled out, Sigma Omega Nu.
 - j. Below that is the name of the University where the Chapter is located.
 - k. Under the University name is the Chapter name.
 - l. On either side of the at are the White and Yellow roses, which represent _____.
 - m. On the sides of the scroll is the year in which the Sorority was established at the designated Chapter.
7. The Crest may also be read by identifying the objects representing each of the objectives. However, this is only an additional way to read the Crest and does not satisfy the requirements of the Reading of the Banner.
 - a. Academics
The Lamp of Knowledge has the letters ΣΩΝ (Sigma Omega Nu) on it, which represents academics and knowledge. Coming out of the Lamp of Knowledge is the

Book of Knowledge which contains the names of the eight Founding Mothers, in no particular order. Behind the Book of Knowledge, is the Sorority symbol, the Sun, which represents _____.

b. Cultura

The pyramid and La Mujer represent Cultura and the Indigenous Roots of the Sisters.

c. Sisterhood

The eight candles represent each of the Founding Mothers as individuals. However, the Laurel Leaves represent the Binding of Sisterhood that holds the eight Founding Mothers and all members together, in addition to representing academics and growth.

Section D. Meanings and Symbols

1. No earlier than 24 hours before the scheduled Crossover, the following symbols and meanings will be revealed to the Little Sisters by the Pledge Mother(s) and the President.

a. $\Sigma\Omega\Nu$

$\Sigma\Omega\Nu$ stands for _____.

b. Founding Date

November 6, 1996 represents the founding date of Sigma Omega Nu

c. Founding Chapter

Cal Poly, San Luis Obispo, Founding Chapter is where Sigma Omega Nu was founded

d. Colors

The colors black, burgundy and gold stand for _____.

e. Roses

White and Yellow roses are the sorority flowers and represent “_____”

f. Sun

The Sun a symbol of our existence. Stands for “_____”

g. $M\Sigma\Psi\Lambda\Sigma$

$M\Sigma\Psi\Lambda\Sigma$ stands for “_____”

h. Objectives

Academics, Cultura, Sisterhood are the three objectives of Sigma Omega Nu

2. At no point may the meanings or symbols be written down by any Big Sisters or Little Sisters.

Section E. Participation

All Active Members are required to attend the Crossover ceremony. Any other Sister who wishes to attend must be in Good Standing in order to be permitted to attend. The Chapter's Sergeant at Arms is responsible for verifying the status of all attendees prior to the ceremony.

Section F. Attire

Sisters must wear professional or business casual attire, along with the Official Sweatshirt.

Section G. Ceremony

1. The Crossover Ceremony marks the official ending of the Big Sister Little Sister process and the addition of New Members into the Sisterhood of Sigma Omega Nu.

2. The Sigma Omega Nu Crest must be displayed at the Ceremony. The Pledge Mother(s) and the Chapter President must stand in front of the Crest and each hold an unlit burgundy candle. A pathway lined with lit candles must lead up to the Crest, where the Sister oath will be read. It is strongly recommended that the Chapter President memorize the oath in advance of the ceremony to ensure a meaningful and uninterrupted presentation.
3. At the start of the pathway, closest to where the Little Sister will enter, three burgundy candles (with each of the objectives written on each candle) will be held by three sisters in the following order:
 - a. Academics: held by an Alumna, or the 2nd oldest member present.
 - b. Cultura: held by a Founding Mother or Founding Sister, or oldest member present.
 - c. Sisterhood: held by the newest member of the most recent pledge class or prospective chapter.
4. The Ceremony is as follows:
 - a. The Little Sister enters the room.
 - b. Simultaneously, the Little Sister is handed a burgundy candle with the Greek Letters ΣΩΝ on it and a crown of laurel leaves is placed on their head.
 - c. The candle is then lit.
 - d. The Little Sister is told to walk forward to light the Academics, Cultura, and Sisterhood candles, then will continue to walk forward to the Chapter President and Pledge Mother(s) at the end of the pathway.
 - e. Chapter President reads the following oath:

Chapter President: "We..."

All Sisters: "Sigma Omega Nu"

Chapter President: "On this day (Month/Day/Year), we the Sisters of Sigma Omega Nu recognize (Full Name) as an official sister of Sigma Omega Nu of the ___ Chapter at (University's Full Name)."

Chapter President: "Do you accept?" [Wait for response] [If yes, the Little Sister lights the Chapter President and the Pledge Mother(s) candle, the Pledge Mother(s) then removes the Little Sister Pin (if applicable)]

[The Big Sister replaces the Little Sister Pin with a White and Yellow Rose boutonniere and a Sister Pin]

Chapter President: "Please step in line"

5. Each New Member is placed in line order, facing away from where the Ceremony is taking place.
6. After all New Members have accepted, the Chapter President and Pledge Mother(s) will keep their candles lit. The Chapter President will bring the Little Sisters back into the room, but still facing away from the Sisters. The Chapter President will then say, "On the count of 3, please turn around and blow out your candles," and will then count to three.

Section H. Sister Pin

Each Little Sister will be presented with the Sister Pin. The Sister pin serves as a symbol of their formal initiation and lifelong commitment to the sisterhood.

Section I. Ceremony Considerations

1. The Crossover Ceremony must be conducted with the utmost respect for the dignity, comfort, and safety of all participants.

2. Little Sisters must be provided with appropriate waiting accommodations. These accommodations must include, at minimum: access to seating, access to a restroom, and access to their personal belongings, including cell phones.
3. Chapters must select a ceremony location that complies with all university policies. Whether held on or off campus, the location must be safe, respectful, inclusive, and approved (if required) through proper university event procedures. Chapters are responsible for verifying and adhering to all applicable university rules regarding venue usage and liability.
4. Chapters may not mislead or redirect Little Sisters to a different, undisclosed venue.
5. Blindfolding is strictly prohibited. No form of sensory deprivation, coercion, or symbolic control (including blindfolds or similar materials) may be used during any part of the ceremony or its preparation.

Section J. Official Paraphernalia

1. Once the New Members have blown out their candles, the Pledge Mother(s) will present each Sister with her Official Sigma Omega Nu sweatshirt and membership certificate. The New Members will be instructed to wear their Official Sweatshirt immediately prior to any other Sigma Omega Nu paraphernalia. In the event the Official Sweatshirts are not available at the time of Crossover, the New Members may borrow another Sister's official sweatshirt to satisfy this requirement.
2. If the Little Sister was wearing her Little Sister Pin, the pin will be returned back to them.

Article XVI. Scroll Numbers and Nicknames

Section A. Scroll Number

1. The New Members of Sigma Omega Nu are to have a scroll number assigned to them. The first New Member in line will take the next number on the Chapter Scroll, and their Line Sisters after that will take the next consecutive numbers.
2. At a newly established Chapter, the scroll numbers 01 through 10 must be reserved for the Founding Sisters of that Chapter. For a chapter with up to 10 Founding sisters, the Beta Class must begin at 11. If there are more than ten Founding Sisters, the Beta Class will begin with the next consecutive number.

Section B. Nicknames

1. The New Members of Sigma Omega Nu are to have a unique Nickname. All those present at the Crossover Ceremony may participate in the giving of nicknames (this includes the New Members). The Chapter Sergeant at Arms is to write down the first ten nicknames given to them by those present, excluding any nicknames deemed to be a repeat. The Vice President of Communications will reference the official Nickname List to ensure the nicknames being suggested do not already exist and do not violate the rules identified in this Section. All those present will then take a vote for their favorite two. The Chapter Sergeant at Arms will be responsible for counting votes. The three nicknames with the highest votes are the nicknames from which the New Member may choose from. Once spoken, the chosen nickname becomes the New Members' personal Sigma Omega Nu nickname. This is to be done on an individual basis for each New Member. The Chapter Sergeant at Arms will

keep the list of each New Member's top three nicknames until all nicknames have been cleared by the National Vice President of Communications.

2. Professional Judgement: Sisters must take caution to nicknames that are racially charged, have negative racial connotations, or perpetuate stereotypes.
3. The newly selected nicknames must be submitted to the National Vice President of Communications within 24 hours after Crossover. In addition to submitting the nicknames, the Pledge Mother(s) must include the definition for each nickname selected, and if in another language, include the English translation. The National Vice President of Communications reserves the right to reject a nickname. If rejected, a reason for denial will be provided, and the New Member will be given the opportunity to select one of the two remaining top three nicknames. In the event more than one Chapter crosses on the same night, nicknames will be accepted in the order that the National Vice President of Communications receives them.
4. Separate from submitting new nicknames within 24 hours after Crossover, each New Member is allowed 7 days after Crossover to personalize her nickname. The only personalization allowed is spelling, capitalization, the use of punctuation, or use of letters from the Greek alphabet in place of letters from the Latin alphabet. The New Member cannot translate into another language, add words or letters, remove words or letters, or anything else that would change the nickname to something other than what was originally suggested.
5. Once a nickname is added to the Master Nickname List, it cannot be changed or appealed unless another Sister believes the nickname of the New Member is a repeat of her own nickname. The Sister may submit a written request for appeal to the National Vice President of Communications, including her justification for why they believe the new nickname to be a repeat of their own.
6. The following are considered repeats of existing nicknames, regardless of intended meaning:
 - a. Adding or removing the/la or miss/ms/mz/mrs to the beginning of an existing nickname or other similar pre-fixes to an existing nickname.
 - b. Adding or removing -ito/a, -on/ona, -issimo/a, -ness, -s/z, -ino/a or other similar endings to the end of an existing nickname.
 - c. Translating an existing nickname into any other language, so long as it is a direct translation only. (Example: Blanca Nieves translates only to Snow White, which is not acceptable).
 - d. Changing the spelling of an existing nickname (example: changing existing Shawty to Shorty).
 - e. Spelling out an acronym, or vice versa (example: spelling out existing IDK to I Don't Know)

- f. Shortened form of an existing nickname, so long as the shortened form means the same as the original (example: Glam is considered a short version of the word Glamorous by the English Dictionary).
 - g. Any combination of the above
- 7. The following are not considered repeats of existing nicknames:
 - a. Using word from existing nicknames, so long as it is not exactly the existing nickname (example: Princess Baby Sparkles is a combination of existing Principessa, Baby Girl, and Sparkles, and is considered acceptable)
 - b. Translations that have many meanings and not a single direct translation. (Example: Paleta could be translated to Popsicle, or palette).
 - c. Different forms of a similar word (example: Glamorous (adjective) is not the same as Glamor (noun)).

Article XVII. Removal

Section A. Circumstances for Removal

The following are considered acceptable reasons for removing a Little Sister from the process. Any situation not listed item must be reviewed and approved by the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs before action is taken.

- 1. Academic & Conduct Related
 - a. Violation of the Alcohol and Drug Policy, refer to Article IX (Minimum Pledgeship Requirements).
 - b. If the process extends into the following academic term, and the Little Sister's term GPA falls below 2.3 and/or cumulative GPA falls below 2.5.
 - c. If the process is completed within the same term it began, and the Little Sister's estimated GPA (as determined by submitted progress reports) falls below a 2.3 term GPA and/or 2.5 cumulative GPA.
 - d. The Little Sister is placed on academic, disciplinary, or conduct probation by the university.
 - e. The Little Sister is no longer enrolled as a full-time undergraduate or part-time graduate student at the university where the Chapter is established.
 - f. The Little Sister engages in a verbal or physical altercation with another Little Sister or Big Sister.
 - g. The Little Sister engages in a verbal or physical altercation with any member of the campus community.
- 2. Pledgeship Performance and Attendance
 - a. Receiving less than 70 points (70%) from the graded assignments (cumulative grade).
 - b. Missing one required non-graded assignment without prior approval from the Pledge Mother(s).
 - c. Failure to attend Progress Interviews without prior notice or without rescheduling with the Pledge Mother(s).

- d. Accumulating four unexcused absences from meetings or activities, as defined in Article IX (Minimum Pledgeship Requirements).
- 3. Violation of Confidentiality & Chapter Integrity
 - a. Disclosing the meanings of Sigma Omega Nu and its symbols to any individual outside of the sorority.
 - b. Speaking negatively about the Chapter or the Organization, including on social media platforms. The Pledge Committee will evaluate the validity and impact of the comment(s). Comments must be demonstrably harmful, defamatory, or disruptive to the Chapter's integrity or operations. Constructive criticism shared through proper channels (chapter meetings, or discussions with officers) will not be considered a violation. A written warning via email will be issued following the first incident. A second incident will result in immediate removal from the process.

Section B. In Case of a Drop

This section outlines the required steps to be taken when a Little Sister is removed from the process or chooses to voluntarily discontinue.

1. Removal from the Big Sister Little Sister process (Involuntary Drop)

If a Little Sister is removed from the process for any of the reasons listed in Section A, the following steps must be followed:

- a. The Pledge Mother(s) must issue a dated and signed removal letter, which must:
 - a. Clearly state the reason(s) for removal, referencing the specific item(s) from Section A.
 - b. Include dates and brief descriptions of the offenses.
 - c. Remind the Little Sister of their oath to confidentiality.
 - d. Indicate whether they are eligible to rejoin a future pledge class.
- b. The Little Sister must sign and return a copy of the letter to the Pledge Mother(s), which will be kept on file. A copy of the letter must be emailed to the following officers within 48 hours: National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs, Chapter President, and Pledge Class President.
- c. The Pledge Mother(s) must collect all issued items from the former Little Sister within one week of the receipt of the removal letter. This includes the binder and the journal.
- d. If requested by the former Little Sister, the Pledge Mother(s) may offer a debriefing to discuss areas for personal improvement or feedback regarding the process.
- e. If eligible and approved to rejoin the Big Sister Little Sister process in a future term, the former Little Sister must begin the process from day one, with no credit for previous participation. They must remain bound by their oath of confidentiality and may not disclose details of the process to their new Pledge Sisters.

2. Voluntary Discontinuation by the Little Sister

If a Little Sister chooses to discontinue the process on their own, the following steps must be followed:

- a. The Pledge Mother(s) must provide the Little Sister with a voluntary discontinuation form to formally document their decision.
- b. The Pledge Mother(s) must also issue a dated and signed discontinuation confirming their decision, the letter must acknowledge their voluntary withdrawal from the Big

Sister Little Sister process and remind them of the ongoing obligation to confidentiality.

- c. The letter must be emailed to the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs, Chapter President, and Pledge Class President.
- d. All materials issued to the Little Sister must be returned within one week of receiving the letter. This includes the binder and the journal.
- e. Should they wish to rejoin the Big Sister Little Sister process in a future term, the former Little Sister must begin the process from day one, with no credit for previous participation. They must remain bound by their oath of confidentiality and may not disclose details of the process to their new Pledge Sisters.

Section C. Lack of Collaboration

If a Pledge Class is unable to collaborate effectively on more than one project, and it becomes clear to the Pledge Mother(s) that specific individual(s) are the consistent source of conflict, the following process must be followed to address and attempt to resolve the issue.

1. Meeting of the Minds

A Meeting of the Minds must be held with the entire Pledge Class. The purpose of this meeting is to allow all members involved to discuss the conflict openly and respectfully. The Pledge Mother(s) will serve solely as neutral facilitations and will not advocate for or against any individual. The goal is to support open communication, identify shared concerns, and promote a solution-oriented mindset. The meeting should focus on resolving the specific collaboration issues, not personal grievances or unrelated matters.

2. Resolution Period

Following the Meeting of the Minds, the Pledge Class will be given a minimum of five days to work toward a solution and improve collaboration. At the next scheduled meeting with the Pledge Mother(s), the Pledge Class President must provide a formal update on the status of the issue and efforts made to resolve it.

3. Escalation and Vote

If the issue remains unresolved after the designated resolution period, the following steps must occur: A formal joint meeting between the Pledge Class and the Pledge Committee must be called to evaluate the situation. A secret ballot vote will be conducted to determine whether the Little Sister(s) identified as the source of continued disruption should be removed from the process.

- a. Voting Requirements

1. A minimum of 3/4 of all voting sisters present (Pledge Class and Pledge Committee combined) must vote in favor of removal for the action to be approved. If the required threshold is not met, the Little Sister(s) must remain in the process.

4. Removal Procedure

If a vote for removal is successful, the Pledge Mother(s) must proceed according to the procedures outlined in Section B. In Case of a Drop, including written documentation, collection of items, and notification to relevant officers.

Article XVIII. New Members

Section A. Recognition

1. After becoming a New Member, each Sister must remove the cover sheet from their binder and replace it with a cover that includes the Greek letters ΣΩΝ in a visible and respectful manner.
2. The Chapter is required to submit an updated Chapter roster to the National Vice President of Communications within one week of the Crossover Ceremony. The roster must follow the official format provided by the National Vice President of Communications. Failure to submit the updated roster by the established deadline may result in fines and loss of Chapter Standards points (refer to Chapter Standards, Section D. Sisterhood, 2. Chapter Roster).

Section B. Post Pledgeship Workshop(s)

1. A Post-Pledgeship Workshop must be conducted by the Pledge Mother(s) prior to the next scheduled General Meeting. The workshop must include: an introduction to meeting procedures, a review of the Chapter's Bylaws, a review of the Chapter's Standing Rules, a review of Standardized Pledgeship, a review of Chapter Standards, and a review of Code of Ethics.
2. If time permits or deemed necessary by the Pledge Mother(s), additional workshops may be scheduled to ensure all required content is adequately covered and understood. Attendance at all scheduled Post-Pledgeship Workshops is mandatory for all New Members.
3. During the first General Meeting following Crossover, each Officer will conduct their duties as usual. Upon completing their report or announcements, each Officer must provide time for New Members to ask questions.
4. At the conclusion of the meeting, the Chapter President will formally invite New Members to ask any additional questions they may have regarding officer responsibilities or the general procedures of Chapter meetings.
5. In the event that any Officer positions are vacant at the time of the meeting, New Members may be nominated for those positions. Once nominated, each candidate must be granted one week to review the full position description before elections are held.
6. The Pledge Mother(s) must submit a signed Event Report form with the Chapter's Chapter Standards submission. Failure to complete the Post Pledgeship Workshop(s) will result in loss of Chapter Standards points (refer to Chapter Standards, Section E. New Member Education, 6. Post Pledgeship Workshops).

Section C. New Member Dues

1. Following Crossover, each New Member is required to pay New Member Dues in the amount of \$75 to the National Board. It is the responsibility of the Chapter to collect these dues from each New Member and/or to cover the cost at the Chapter level to ensure full and timely payment. The Chapter must submit payment to the National Board in full by the established deadline, as communicated by the National Board.
2. If the Chapter elects to advance the payment on behalf of a New Member, the Chapter may add the amount to the New Member's individual account balance at the Chapter level.

The Chapter may also, at its discretion, coordinate payment plans directly with New Members to facilitate reimbursement.

3. Failure to submit payment on time will result in fines and loss of Chapter Standards points (refer to Chapter Standards, Section G. Finances, 1. Chapter Dues).

Article XIX. Big Sister Requirements

Section A. Personal Big Sister Selection Process

1. Eligibility Requirements for Personal Big Sisters

To be considered as a Personal Big Sister, a Sister must meet all of the following criteria:

- a. Completed Interview: The sister must have participated in an interview with the Little Sisters.
- b. Application: A Big Sister Application must be submitted by the deadline set by the Pledge Mother(s).
- c. Active Status: Only members in active status may be considered, to include active alumnae.
- d. Graduating seniors not holding full active status may be considered.
- e. The following status are not eligible: actives on academic or disciplinary probation, and sisters listed as active special circumstances, inactive, or suspended.
- f. GPA Requirement: The sister must meet a minimum term GPA of 2.3 and a cumulative GPA of 2.5 both prior to and throughout the process. They must also be in good academic standing with the university for the entire duration of the process. If a sister falls below the GPA requirements after being assigned a Little Sister, the Pledge Mother(s) must immediately remove them from the big sister role.
- g. Financial Standing: The sister must either have a cleared account balance or be consistently making payments toward their balance.
- h. Required Trainings: Attendance at the pre-pledgeship workshop.
- i. Standing: All potential big sisters must be in good standing with both the chapter and the national board.

2. Criteria Considered in the Pairing Process

When determining the most appropriate Big Sister for each Little Sister, the Pledge Mother(s) and Pledge Committee will consider:

- a. Previous Pairings: The number of previous Little Sisters a Sister has mentored, and the quality of those relationships.
- b. Academic Standing and Class Year: Avoid pairing graduating seniors with first year Little Sisters and first year Big Sisters with transfer Little Sisters.
- c. Current Commitments: Consider the sister's ability to manage her academic, professional, personal, and sorority obligations. Evaluate their involvement in Chapter, National Board, family, work, or other organizations.
- d. Personality and Strengths: Assess the academic, personal, and social strengths and weaknesses of both the Sister and Little Sister to determine if the pairing would be supportive, balance, and compatible.

- e. Chapter Dynamics: Consider whether pairing may reinforce, disrupt, or heal cliques or social tension within the chapter.
- 3. Pairing Procedure

Once all big sister applications and little sister preferences have been submitted, the Pledge Mother(s) and Pledge Committee will meet to review materials and propose pairings.

 - a. Pairings should be finalized through consensus. If consensus cannot be reached, a vote will be held among the Pledge Mother(s) and Pledge Committee. In the event of a tie, voting will continue until a majority decision is reached. The Chapter President may not break a tie, as doing so may present a conflict of interest.
- 4. Notification and Confirmation

Once the pairings have been finalized and approved, selected big sisters will be notified via email. Personal big sister assignments are not to be announced to the full chapter until they have been both approved and accepted.
- 5. Acceptance and Integrity of the Pairing
 - a. Big Sisters may accept or decline their assigned Little Sister. However, they may not request to trade or switch once assignments are made.
 - b. Any sisters who bad-mouth, criticizes, gossips about, or otherwise disrespects any aspect of the selection process, including individual little sisters or the pairing decisions, will be automatically removed from consideration as a Personal Big Sister. This includes verbal comments, messages, or social media behavior. The selection process must remain confidential, respectful, and supportive at all times.
 - c. All assignments are considered final once accepted.

Section B. Personal Big Sister Requirements

- 1. After the Pledge Mother(s) have announced the Personal Big Sisters, the Pledge Mother(s) must contact the Personal Big Sisters within a week of the announcement and provide details on their roles and responsibilities.
- 2. The Personal Big Sisters are required to complete the following:
 - a. Attend the Big Sister Little Sister Dinner
 - b. Date with the Little Sister
 - c. Attend the Crossover Ceremony

Article XX. Hazing Policy

Section A. Applicability

All Sisters of Sigma Omega Nu must abide by the Hazing Policy as outlined in Article XV (Risk Management) of the Chapter Bylaws, and Article VIII (Hazing Policy) of the National Board Standing Rules. The following additional provisions apply and must be strictly observed.

Section B. Standards of Conduct During Pledgeship

- 1. All Prospective New Members and Little Sisters of Sigma Omega Nu are to be treated with the same level of dignity and respect as initiated members.
- 2. The entire process must fully adhere to the Standardized Pledgeship guidelines, as approved by the National Board. No Chapter or individual sister may alter or deviate from these guidelines.

Section C. Acts of Hazing

1. No initiated sister may request, require, or engage in any act involving Little Sisters that could reasonably be interpreted as hazing under federal, state, or university law or policy.
2. Hazing includes, but is not limited to, acts that are degrading, humiliating, physical or mentally abusive, verbally abusive, intentionally cruel, harmful, or illegal in nature.
3. Strictly prohibited actions include: paddling/spanking, kidnapping or involuntary transport, carrying of large/heavy objects, forced consumption of food or drink, forced masturbation, branding, nudity, hosing, servitude, or exposure to extreme elements or conditions. Additionally, any task assigned solely for the amusement, pleasure, or benefit of initiated sisters is strictly prohibited.
4. Any indirect or implied requests, including those framed as “optional,” “tradition,” or “expected,” that result in pressure, stress, or discomfort for Little Sisters will be considered acts of hazing. Any “unofficial” or unsanctioned practices passed down informally are strictly prohibited.
5. Requiring or implying that Little Sisters must be “on call”, available at all hours for tasks, communication, or check ins, is considered a form of hazing and is strictly prohibited. No Little Sister may be expected to: respond to calls, texts, or messages immediately or at unreasonable hours; remain alert, accessible, or on standby 24/7; carry out unscheduled tasks or report their location or availability at all times; or participate in errands, activities, or meetings at the demand of active members.
6. All communication with Little Sisters must occur during reasonable hours, respect personal boundaries, academic obligations, and individual well-being, and be voluntary.
7. No initiated sister who has consumed alcohol, illegal substances, or any mind-altering drugs may participate in any official Little Sister meeting, activity or event until a minimum of twelve (12) hours has passed since the time of consumption. Such sisters are also prohibited from issuing assignments or giving directives to any Little Sister during that period.

Section D. Pledge Mother Contract

1. Prior to the Pinning Ceremony, all Pledge Mother(s) must sign the Pledge Mother Contract, affirming their commitment to uphold the Hazing Policy at all times, and confirming compliance with all applicable university policies. Failure to submit this contract is grounds for immediate removal from position.
2. Signed contracts must be submitted to the National Board President and the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs prior to the start of the process.
3. The Pledge Mother(s) are responsible for ensuring that all Chapter Sisters fully comply with Sigma Omega Nu’s Hazing Policy and all applicable University policies.

Section E. Chapter Sister Contract

1. Prior to the Pinning Ceremony, all Chapter Sisters eligible to participate in the process, must sign the Chapter Sister Contract, confirming compliance with both the Sigma Omega Nu Hazing Policy and all applicable university policies. This requirement includes any Alumnae who intend to participate in the process.
2. It is the duty of the Pledge Mother(s) to collect all signed Chapter Sister Contracts and retain them on file until the conclusion of the process.

Section F. Judicial Consequences

1. Any sister who violates the Hazing Policy will be subject to Judicial Review by the National Judicial Committee.
2. Chapters are required to report any hazing allegations, incidents, or violations immediately to the National Board. This applies regardless of whether the issue has already been addressed or resolved at the Chapter level. Failure to report a known or suspected violation will result in additional disciplinary action against the Chapter and/or its Pledge Mother(s) and Executive Board.
3. A Cease and Desist Directive is a written order issued by the National Board in response to reported hazing allegations that may violate the Hazing Policy and Code of Ethics. The directive requires the Chapter to immediately stop all pledgship activities for the current term or until otherwise notified, initiating the sorority's judicial review process. Please refer to Article XV (Risk Management) for more detailed information on the Cease and Desist Directive related to hazing allegations.

Article XXI. Privacy Policy

Section A. Prohibited Content

The following content is strictly prohibited from being posted on any social media platforms:

1. Any pictures taken before, during, or after the Pinning Ceremony, regardless of content, including pictures featuring the Crest, Banner, or any ceremonial items (candles/etc.).
2. Any pictures taken before or during the Big Sister Little Sister Potluck, regardless of content.
3. Any pictures taken before or during the Crossover Ceremony, regardless of content, including pictures featuring the Crest, Banner, or any ceremonial items (candles, laurel leaves, etc.).
4. Content related to pledgship activities or assignments that are not open to or publicly known by non-members.
5. Lists of the names of Little Sisters, in part or in full.
6. Captions, labels, posts, tags, or any other identifiers that disclose or hint at any of the prohibited content listed above.
7. Creation or use of pledge class specific social media accounts that reference, display, or imply any internal aspects of the Big Sister Little Sister process (for example, pledge class Instagram accounts, or Big/Little Reveal accounts).

Section B. Permitted Content

The following content may be posted on social media only under the conditions specified:

1. Assignments or activities that are open to the general public, such as community service events, fundraisers, or the class gift, may be posted without restriction.
2. Pictures taken with Little Sisters following the Big Sister Little Sister Potluck must be taken away from the location of the actual ceremony or event such that a non-member cannot identify the context in which the picture was taken. Pictures taken at the Potluck may only be shared after Crossover has occurred.

3. Pictures taken after the Crossover Ceremony may be shared so long as no ceremonial items (candles, laurel leaves, or boutonnieres) are visible. Pictures must be taken away from the location of the actual ceremony such that a non-member cannot identify the context in which the picture was taken. The Crest/Banner cannot be visible in the picture.
4. Chapters and Sisters must wait at minimum 24 hours from crossover to post pictures of newly crossed Sisters.

Section C. Consequences

Failure to comply with the guidelines outlined in Section A or Section B may result in Judicial Review of the individual Sister by the Chapter and/or Judicial Review of the Chapter by the National Board, as provided in the Code of Ethics.

Appendices

Appendix A: Assignments, Grading and Meeting Breakdown

Graded Assignments Breakdown

Assignment	Points
Big Sister Paddle	5 Points
Budgeting 101: Tentative Budget	5 Points
Chapter Officer Interviews	5 Points
Class Gift Fundraiser	5 Points
Family Traditions & Cultural Project	5 Points
Pledge Class T-shirt Design	5 Points
Journal Decoration	5 Points
Big Sister Interviews	10 Points
Pledge Class Fundraiser	10 Points
Pledge Class Interviews	10 Points
Pledge Class Paddle	10 Points
Scholarship Pursuit: Research, Presentation, and Application	10 Points
Sexual Assault Awareness Research	10 Points
Total	100 Points

Grading Scale

A = 90-100%

B = 80-89%

C = 70-79%

D = 60-69%

F = Below 60%

Non-Graded Assignments

While the following assignments do not contribute to the final points total, they are essential components of the process. They are designed to foster personal growth, sisterhood bonding, and overall preparedness for becoming a member of Sigma Omega Nu. There are two types of non-graded assignments, Required (Pass/Fail) and Optional.

1. Required (Pass/Fail): These assignments must be completed to remain eligible for crossover, regardless of the number of points earned from graded assignments. Completion is evaluated on a Pass/Fail basis, such as submitted or not submitted, and/or attended or not attended.
2. Optional: These assignments are highly encouraged for their personal benefit and to enrich their experience, but not mandatory for crossover eligibility.

Required (Pass/Fail) Assignments:

1. Allergy and Dietary Information

2. Journal Questions
3. Pledge Class Meetings
4. Professional Attire
5. Personal Big Sisters
6. Progress Report Submission
7. Community Service Hours
8. Big Sister Little Sister Frame Exchange
9. Big Sister Little Sister Potluck
10. Person of Importance
11. Pledge Class Picture
12. Practice Informationals
13. Big Sister/Little Sister Date
14. Pledge Class Scrapbook
15. Chapter Founding Sister(s) & Alumnae Panel Questions

Optional Assignments:

1. Email Etiquette
2. SON Family Tree
3. Chant

Activities:

Participation in the activities listed below is required and will be monitored for attendance. A letter of excuse is required if the Little Sister is not able to attend.

1. Officer Elections
2. Candlelight Ceremonies – Person of Importance
 1. Opening Ceremony
 2. Closing Ceremony
3. Chapter Founding Sister(s) & Alumnae Panel

Final Grading:

Final Grade is based on completion and performance on point-based assignments (100 total points). Little Sisters must receive a minimum of 70 points (70%) from the graded assignments to be considered for crossover.

All Required (Pass/Fail) Assignments must be completed. Missing one required non-graded assignment without prior approval from the Pledge Mother(s) may result in ineligibility for crossover.

Please note: Attendance based requirements, such Pledge Class Meetings, please make sure to follow the attendance requirements (refer to Article IX. Minimum Pledgeship Requirements).

Meeting 1 (Following Pinning Ceremony)

Introduction: Pledge Mother(s) and Pledge Committee

This meeting marks the official start of the Big Sister Little Sister process. The Little Sisters have already participated in the Pinning Ceremony, which may have been a new and unfamiliar experience. To begin, the Pledge Mother(s) should introduce themselves and explain the overall purpose and significance of the process. They should also provide an overview of the requirements and expectations.

While this may feel like a lot of information at once, the Pledge Mother(s) should reassure the Little Sisters that they will be fully supported throughout the process. The Pledge Committee should be introduced, along with a clear explanation of their role. Any Active Members present should also be introduced, with an emphasis on how they will provide guidance and support. This process is a shared experience, and Active Members will be there every step of the way.

If time allows, it is recommended for the Pledge Mother(s) to allow for each Little Sister to briefly introduce themselves (for example, name, major, and hometown). At the end of the meeting, the Little Sisters should be encouraged to exchange contact information to begin building connections within their class.

Goal: To introduce the structure, purpose, and support system of the Big Sister Little Sister process while fostering initial connections and a sense of community among the Pledge Class.

Activity:

1. **Pinning Ceremony** (refer to Article VIII. Bids & Pinning Ceremony for more information)

Binder Content:

The following documents must be provided in hardcopy at this meeting.

1. Pledge Committee Contact Information
The name, phone number, and email of all members of the Pledge Committee.
2. Minimum Pledgeship Requirements
3. Community Service Form
4. Progress Report Form

Knowledge to Assign:

1. Greek Alphabet
2. Sorority Facts
This includes the Colors, Symbol, Flowers, Objectives, and Sorority Nicknames.

New Assignments:

1. **Allergy and Dietary Information (Due Meeting 2)**
Little Sisters are asked to provide a list of any allergies or dietary restrictions, with the option to include emergency contact information. Allergy and dietary details will be used as needed,

particularly when planning events involving food. Emergency contact information will remain confidential and accessible only to the Pledge Mother(s).

Purpose: To ensure the safety and well-being of all Little Sisters by providing the Pledge Mother(s) with allergy and dietary information for event planning, and optional emergency contacts to support appropriate action in case of a health-related emergency.

Objective: Risk Management

2. **Pledge Class Meetings (Due Meeting 2)** (refer to Article XII. Pledge Class Meetings for more information)

These are the weekly meetings that the Pledge Class will have with their Pledge Mother(s). In coordination with their Pledge Mother(s), the Pledge Class is to find a day and time that works well for everyone.

Purpose: The purpose of the pledge class meetings is to facilitate communication, education, planning, and progress throughout the process. Meetings are designed to provide structured time for completing assignments, reviewing expectations, engaging in educational development, and strengthening the unity of the pledge class. These meetings also prepare Little Sisters for the structure, responsibilities, and culture of future chapter meetings as Active Members.

Objectives: Sorority Operations

3. **Professional Attire (Beginning Meeting 2)**

Little Sisters are expected to learn and practice dressing professionally. Beginning with Meeting 2 and continuing through the end of the process, each Little Sister must wear professional attire (either business casual or business professional) to their Pledge Class Meeting. The Pledge Mother(s) will explain what qualifies as professional attire and will also dress accordingly to model the expectation. There are no restrictions on colors, and Little Sisters are not required to dress alike.

Purpose: Sigma Omega Nu Sisters are expected to present themselves professionally, and must also follow this requirement for Chapter Meetings. As college students, learning to dress appropriately prepares sisters for interviews, internships, and other professional settings.

Objective: Professionalism

4. **Pledge Class Interviews (Due Meeting 3)**

Each member of the Pledge Class will conduct one-on-one interviews with their fellow Pledge Sisters. These interviews should be recorded in the Pledgeship Journal.

Purpose: This assignment promotes individual interactions, allowing each member to personally connect with and get to know their Pledge Sisters on a personal level.

Objective: Sisterhood & Relationship Building

5. **Journal Decoration (Due Meeting 2)** (refer to Article X. Journal for more information)

Each Little Sister must receive a journal, the journal must be a standard composition notebook, not exceeding 10.25 inches by 8 inches in size. Each Little Sister will have one week from the day they receive the journal to decorate it. The journal must be decorated on both the front and back side; the Little Sister's name must be clearly displayed on the front. Decoration is intended to reflect each individual's personality and creativity; all other design elements are left to the discretion of the Little Sister. Throughout the Big Sister Little Sister process, the Pledge Mother(s) will assign weekly writing prompts for the entire pledge class.

Purpose: The journal is a confidential space intended for Little Sisters to reflect honestly on their experience without fear or judgement or repercussions. Journals may be used as a way for the Pledge Mother(s) to gain insight into the Big Sister Little Sister process and identify areas for improvement, ensuring the experience remains meaningful and supportive.

Objective: Reflection & Feedback

6. **Officer Nominations** (refer to Article XI. Pledge Class Officers for more information)

Before officer elections take place, the Pledge Class begin with a nomination period to identify candidates interested in serving as class officers. Little Sisters may nominate themselves or other Pledge Sisters, but all nominees must confirm their willingness to run prior to the vote. To support informed participation, the Pledge Mother(s) will provide the officer role descriptions so that all Little Sisters can review the responsibilities associated with each position.

Purpose: To provide structure, leadership, and accountability within the pledge class throughout the Big Sister Little Sister process. The positions offer an opportunity for early leadership development and serves as a foundation for understanding the expectations of full membership in Sigma Omega Nu.

Objective: Sorority Operations & Professional Development

7. **Journal Question #1 (Due Meeting 2):** What are your thoughts and/or emotions after the Pinning Ceremony?
8. **Journal Question #2 (Due Meeting 2):** Do you have any questions or concerns as you begin the process?

Meeting 2 (Week 1)

Introduction: Chapter President

The Pledge Mother(s) should determine in advance how much time the Chapter President will be allotted to present.

Since it is only Week 1, and Little Sisters may still be adjusting to the process and getting to know one another, it is important for the Pledge Mother(s) to ensure that they understand the requirements and expectations will help facilitate a smooth transition into what is expected of them as Sisters.

During this meeting, the Chapter President should clearly outline what will be expected once the Little Sisters complete the process and become Sisters of Sigma Omega Nu. Transparency is key to helping them understand the commitment involved in joining the sorority. The Chapter President should explain the roles and responsibilities of Active Sisters (refer to Chapter Bylaws Article VI. Membership) and introduce the different membership statuses available at the chapter level, such as Active, Inactive, and Active Special Circumstance. While the organization encourages Sisters to remain Active throughout their undergraduate years, it is helpful to inform the Little Sisters of the options available if circumstances change. This introduction provides insight into the internal structure and operations of the sorority.

Additionally, the Chapter President may share their own responsibilities and experiences in their role. This includes an overview of their duties at the chapter level as well as the chapter's obligations

to the National Board. They may also highlight national events, council meetings, and nearby chapters, emphasizing opportunities for connection and national/regional engagement.

Goal: To provide Little Sisters with a clear understanding of the responsibilities, expectations, and long-term commitment of sisterhood, while offering insight into how the chapter functions within the larger organization.

Activity:

1. Officer Nominations

The Pledge Mother(s) will allocate time during this meeting to open the nomination period. During this time, Little Sisters may nominate themselves or other Pledge Sisters. Nominees may accept or decline their nominations during the meeting or at the following meeting, prior to elections.

Assignments:

1. Big Sister Interviews (Due Meeting 4)

Each member of the Pledge Class will conduct one-on-one interviews with the Chapter's Active Members who are eligible to become Big Sisters. Those not interested or not eligible to become Big Sisters may conduct group interviews with the Pledge Class. These interviews should be recorded in the Pledgeship Journal.

Purpose: This assignment supports the primary goal of the process, which is becoming an integrated member of the Chapter. These interviews provide an opportunity for Little Sisters to build personal connections with current members.

Objective: Sisterhood & Relationship Building

2. Personal Big Sister List (Due Meeting 4) (refer to Article XIX. Big Sister Requirements for more information)

The Pledge Mother(s) will provide the Little Sisters a list of eligible members who can be considered as a Big Sister. Little Sisters will select five eligible Active Members from among those they interviewed whom they would like as their Personal Big Sister. For each of their choices, Little Sisters must write at minimum a paragraph explaining why they selected that particular member. The five names should not be listed in order of preference. The Pledge Mother(s) and Pledge Committee will review these choices and collaborate to assign each Little Sister her Personal Big Sister.

Purpose: The Personal Big Sister will serve as the Little Sister's mentor and guide throughout the process, offering support in personal, academic, and sorority matters. They should be someone the Little Sister feels comfortable approaching for advice and guidance.

Objective: Sisterhood & Mentorship

3. Email Etiquette Draft (Due Meeting 3)

Each Little Sister will draft a mock email addressed to a professor (or other professional figure) using a given scenario, for example, requesting the progress report form to be completed, asking for clarification on an assignment, or inquiring about office hours. The email must follow professional standards and include: a clear subject line, proper greeting and closing, a concise/respectful tone, correct grammar and spelling, and a clear purpose and call to action (what they are asking of or informing them about).

Purpose: This assignment helps Little Sisters develop essential communication skills that are valuable in both academic and professional environments. Writing professional emails not only shows respect but also helps them build credibility and confidence in formal interactions.

Objective: Professional Development

4. Pledge Class Scrapbook (Check-In Meeting 6)

At the start of the process, the Pledge Class will be assigned the task of creating a scrapbook to document their journey. This scrapbook may be physical or digital, depending on the Pledge Class's preference. It can include photos and reflections from all major public assignments and events, such as the fundraiser and community service project, as well as symbols that represent their experiences. The scrapbook may also be used as a creative tool during future recruitment. The cost of the scrapbook will be covered by the Pledgeship dues.

Purpose: To document and celebrate the Pledge Class's shared experiences throughout the process, and to be used to inspire future members during recruitment.

Objective: Sisterhood & Class Representation

5. Person of Importance (Due Meeting 3)

In preparation for an activity that will take place during next week's meeting, Each Little Sister is to come prepared to share a short story about a person of importance in their life. This could be someone who has inspired them, supported them through a difficult time, shaped their values, or made a lasting impact on their personal life. No written submission is required unless the Little Sister will not be present for the activity. In place, the Little Sister will submit a brief submission for the Pledge Mother(s) to share.

Purpose: To encourage reflection on meaningful personal connections and foster deeper understanding among the Pledge Class through storytelling.

Objective: Cultura & Relationship Building

6. Journal Question #3 (Due Meeting 3): What do you look for in a personal Big Sister, both personally and within the sisterhood?

Meeting 3 (Week 2)

Introduction: Chapter Vice President

The Pledge Mother(s) should determine in advance how much time the Chapter Vice President will be allotted to present.

Since academics are one of Sigma Omega Nu's objectives, this meeting should focus on emphasizing the importance of maintaining strong academic performance, not only during the process but also as Active Members. The Chapter Vice President, along with the Pledge Mother(s), should explain the academic expectations and support systems in place. All members, including Little Sisters, are expected to strive for scholastic excellence. This is encouraged through required study hours, submission of progress reports, attendance at office hours, and prioritization of coursework.

The Chapter Vice President can explain their role at the chapter level, which may include collecting grades after each academic term, reviewing progress reports, monitoring study hours, and

recognizing members who excel academically. This is also a great opportunity to introduce what Alpha Order is, and the Mentorship Program.

Additionally, the Chapter Vice President or Pledge Mother(s) should review best practices for academic success, and tips for writing professional emails (reviewing their submissions from the Email Etiquette Draft assignment). These skills will help Little Sisters when communicating with professors, especially when requesting progress reports, and are valuable in any professional setting.

Goal: To emphasize the importance of academic success within Sigma Omega Nu by outlining expectations, support resources, and professional communication skills that will help Little Sisters thrive both during the process and as Active Members.

Activities:

1. **Officer Elections** (refer to Article XI. Pledge Class Officers for more information)
The Pledge Mother(s) will allocate time during this meeting to conduct officer elections. Before voting begins, additional nominations may be accepted, and any previously nominated Little Sisters may choose to decline their nominations. Elections must be conducted by secret ballot to ensure fairness and confidentiality. While the Pledge Committee collects and counts the ballots, the Pledge Mother(s) will continue with the meeting. The elected officers will be announced at the end of the meeting.
2. **Candlelight Opening (Person of Importance)**
The Candlelight Opening Ceremony must take place immediately following the meeting. All Active Members are required to attend and participate.
All attendees (Little Sisters and Big Sisters) will receive a white candle and are to form a circle (either seated or standing). The Pledge Mother(s) will begin by explaining the purpose of the ceremony, to reflect on and share about a person of importance in their lives.
To start, the Pledge Mother(s) will light their own candle and share a brief story about someone who has had a meaningful impact on them. They will then light the candle of the first Little Sister in the circle. Each Little Sister will share a story about their person of importance and then light the candle of the Pledge Sister to their left.
This process continues until all Little Sisters and Big Sisters have shared and all candles are lit. Once everyone has spoken, the Pledge Mother(s) will lead the group in blowing out their candles simultaneously, and thanking everyone for sharing.
Purpose: To create space for vulnerability, connection and shared values, which are key elements of sisterhood in Sigma Omega Nu.
Objective: Cultura & Relationship Building

Knowledge to Assign:

1. Founding Mother Scrolls
2. Sorority Establishment Date

Assignments:

1. **Scholarship Pursuit: Research, Presentation, and Application**

This assignment highlights the importance of actively seeking opportunities and utilizing available resources to support your academic and professional growth. The assignment is divided into three parts.

Part 1 Research (Due Meeting 4): Little Sisters will research and identify at least three scholarships or internships related to their fields of interest. Submissions must include direct links and eligibility requirements for review and approval by the Pledge Mothers. Note: These opportunities must require more than simply entering an email address or basic contact information.

Part 2 Presentation (Due Meeting 5): Little Sisters will create a brief presentation (1-3 PPT slides) outlining their chosen field of interest, scholarship/internship objectives and requirements, and describing why these selected opportunities align with their academic or career goals.

Part 3 Applying (Due Meeting 8): Little Sisters need to have applied or completed their applications by the second to last meeting of the process and submit a confirmation screenshot of email to the Pledge Mother(s).

Purpose: This assignment helps Little Sisters develop scholarship/internship application skills while strengthening research, writing, and time management. It encourages balancing academics with other responsibilities and prepares them for future opportunities by connecting personal interests with real-world experiences.

Objective: Academics & Professional Development

2. **Practice Informationals** (refer to Article XIII. Quizzes for more information)

The Pledge Class will prepare and deliver a formal presentation that includes the following:

- a. A slideshow or visual component (PPT, Google Slides)
- b. Professional dress attire at the time of presentation
- c. Content prepared and presented individually
- d. A focus on the history, values, and identity of Sigma Omega Nu

The presentation should mirror the structure and professional expected during official chapter informationals, particularly those held during Rush. The Pledge Mother(s) will share with the Pledge Class a copy of the chapter's presentation for reference.

Purpose: To reinforce the Little Sisters' understanding of Sigma Omega Nu's history, purpose, and values; develop public speaking and presentation skills; prepare Little Sisters to lead rush informationals and represent the sorority confidently in future recruitment efforts.

Objective: Sorority Operations & Professional Development

3. **Big Sister Little Sister Potluck**

The Big Sister Reveal will take place as a potluck style dinner hosted by a designated Big Sister Committee, who will work with the Chapter's Active Members to provide the food and secure the location. The Chapter will decide whether the cost of the food can be covered by Chapter funds, or if Chapter members will be responsible for covering the cost out of pocket. Little Sisters will form their own committee to collaborate with the Big Sister Committee on choosing a theme, planning ice breakers, and organizing decorations. Little Sisters are encouraged to contribute by providing decorations and essentials such as plates, napkins, utensils, and cups. The Pledge Mother(s) will schedule the dinner based on the availability of the Pledge Class and the Chapter. The Pledge Mother(s) are responsible for informing the Active Members and any other invited members (for example, alumnae) of the

date, time, and coordinating the RSVP process. They will also share any special dietary needs in advance so accommodations can be made. At the dinner, each Little Sister's Personal Big Sister will be revealed, marking a meaningful milestone in the process.

Note: Given time constraints, the Big Sister Committee may begin planning (tentative dates and locations) at the beginning of the process to ensure the potluck can be completed by Meeting 5 (Week 4).

Purpose: This special event celebrates the formation of a lasting bond between Big and Little Sisters. It also teaches collaboration, creativity, and thoughtful planning, as Little Sisters work together with the Big Sisters to create a welcoming and memorable experience.

Objective: Sisterhood & Event Planning

4. Big Sister Little Sister Frame Exchange (Due at Big Sister Little Sister Potluck)

At the Big Sister/Little Sister Potluck, each Little Sister will present their Personal Big Sister with a decorated picture frame as a gift. The frame must include the words "Big Sister," "Little Sister," and "Sigma Omega Nu". The design, style, and size of the frame are up to the Little Sister's discretion. To help with personalization, the Pledge Mother(s) will provide each Little Sister with a list of her Big Sister's likes and favorites. As part of the exchange, each Little Sister will also receive a decorated frame from their Personal Big Sister.

Purpose: This gift represents the beginning of a meaningful bond between you and your Big Sister. It is a symbol of appreciation, connection, and sisterhood. The time and thought you put into creating it should reflect not only who you are but also the unique relationship you are beginning to build. This exchange marks a special moment in your journey together and honors the values of support, mentorship, and unity within Sigma Omega Nu.

Objective: Sisterhood

5. Pledge Class Fundraiser

The Pledge Class is responsible for organizing and executing a fundraiser to support process related expenses. This assignment provides the class an opportunity to develop a detailed plan, including logistics, a tentative budget, promotional ideas, and a fundraising goal. It is up to the Pledge Class to decide on the type of fundraiser, but Pledge Mother(s) may provide examples of past Chapter fundraisers and the pros/cons of each, to help guide the decision-making process. The Fundraising Chair will be responsible for preparing a financial report, noting the revenue and expenses, and the final profit or loss. All funds raised must be documented and reported to the Pledge Mother(s), and submitted to the Chapter Treasurer.

Purpose: To foster collaboration, financial planning, and event executing skills while raising funds to support the pledge class's activities and responsibilities.

Objective: Sorority Operations & Event Planning

6. Pledge Class T-shirt Design (Due Meeting 4)

The Pledge Class will design a t-shirt to represent their class. The design must include the following elements:

- a. Sigma Omega Nu
- b. Chapter Name
- c. University Name/Location
- d. Pledge Class Nickname
- e. First Names of all Pledge Class Members
- f. Term and Year of Pledgeship

The overall design is up to the discretion of the Pledge Class; this includes the kind of t-shirt, color, font style, and layout. The t-shirts do not need to be professionally printed; Little Sisters are welcome to create their own using methods such as iron-ons, fabric paint, or other creative approaches.

Purpose: To work together toward a shared goal while creating something that celebrates their identity, team work, and pledge class spirit.

Objective: Team Building

7. **Journal Question #4 (Due Meeting 4):** How did the Person of Importance ceremony resonate with you personally?
8. **Journal Question #5 (Due Meeting 4):** How do you friends and/or family feel about your decision to join a sorority?

Meeting 4 (Week 3)

Introduction: Chapter Treasurer

The Pledge Mother(s) should determine in advance how much time the Chapter Treasurer will be allotted to present.

Now that the process is underway and Little Sisters have begun planning events, it is important they gain an understanding of how chapter finances are managed. The Chapter Treasurer should explain their role at the chapter level, including an overview of dues, what they are, what they typically cover, and the importance of budgeting for events.

The Chapter Treasurer should also outline best practices for submitting both tentative and final budgets and highlight the role of fundraising in supporting chapter activities. To provide practical insight, the Chapter Treasurer should share examples of a tentative and final budget. The presentation should conclude with a Q&A session to address any questions the Little Sisters may have.

Goal: To introduce Little Sisters to the basics of chapter finances, including the purpose of dues, budgeting practices, and the importance of fundraising, in preparation for planning future events.

Knowledge to Assign:

1. Chapter Founding Sister Scrolls
2. Chapter Establishment Date

Assignments:

1. Budgeting 101: Tentative Budget (Due Meeting 5)

The Pledge Mother(s) will assign the Little Sister(s) to create a tentative budget for an upcoming event. In order to connect the assignment to the chapter, it is recommended that the Pledge Mother(s) use events that exist at the chapter (for example, fundraisers, retreats, socials, formal), as well as give the Little Sisters the number of members to plan for, and/or the budget amount.

Purpose: This assignment introduces Little Sisters to the fundamentals of sorority financial planning and responsible event budgeting. By learning directly from the Chapter Treasurer and creating a tentative budget of their own, Little Sisters will gain practical skills in

organization and event planning. This experience prepares them to contribute meaningfully to future chapter operations and deepens their understanding of the behind the scenes work that keeps Sigma Omega Nu running effectively and sustainably.

Objective: Sorority Operations

2. Chapter Officer Interviews (Due Meeting 5)

The Pledge Mother(s) will provide the Pledge Class with a list of Chapter Officer positions, their descriptions, and who holds the positions at the Chapter level. Each Little Sister must interview 2-3 officers of positions they are interested in. The Little Sister must ask questions regarding their duties and responsibilities of the particular office. Interviews must be recorded in their journal.

Purpose: To help Little Sisters gain insight into Chapter leadership roles by encouraging direct engagement with current officers.

Objective: Sorority Operations & Leadership Development

3. Pledge Class Picture (Due Meeting 6)

The Pledge Class is required to coordinate a group picture, similar in style to the Chapter's annual photoshoots. All Little Sisters must wear coordinated outfits in either semi-formal or business casual attire. The overall style and theme of the photo are left to the discretion of the Pledge Class. The Pledge Class must submit digital copies to the Pledge Mother(s).

Purpose: The picture represents the bond your Pledge Class has built throughout the Pledgeship Process and serves as a lasting memory shared with the Chapter.

Objective: Sisterhood & Class Representation

4. Pledge Class Paddle (Due Meeting 6)

The Pledge Class is required to create a class paddle, which will become the property of Sigma Omega Nu. The paddle must include the following:

- a. Greek Letters of the Sorority (ΣΩΝ)
- b. Pledge Class Name (Nickname Optional)
- c. Full Name (First and Last) of all Pledge Class Members
- d. Term and Year of Pledgeship

The paddle's size, shape, weight, style, and décor (using sorority colors) are left to the discretion of the Pledge Class. However, it should be practical in size, something any member could reasonably carry around campus.

Past Pledge Classes will be asked to bring and share their own class paddle during the meeting when this assignment is introduced, to inspire and guide the current pledge class.

Purpose: Paddles are an old Greek tradition. Fraternities and sororities have stopped using them for hazing, and are now decorated as a symbol of pride for the organization. This assignment allows the pledge class to contribute to that tradition and create a symbol that represents their shared experience. The size restriction is not meant to limit their creativity, but to ensure their design is both thoughtful and practical for future use and display.

Objective: Sisterhood & Class Representation

5. Scholarship Pursuit: Part 2 Presentation (Previously introduced in Meeting 3)

Little Sisters will create a brief presentation (1-3 PPT slides) outlining their chosen field of interest, scholarship/internship objectives and requirements, and describing why these selected opportunities align with their academic or career goals.

6. **Journal Question #6 (Due Meeting 5):** How well do you feel you and your Pledge Sisters are working together? What obstacles have you faced as a group?

Meeting 5 (Week 4)

Introduction: Chapter Sergeant at Arms

The Pledge Mother(s) should determine in advance how much time the Chapter Sergeant at Arms will be allotted to present.

The Chapter Sergeant at Arms (SAA) plays a vital role in upholding the Chapter Bylaws and Code of Ethics by working closely with the Chapter President and other officers to ensure all Members follow established policies. During this meeting, the Chapter SAA should provide the Little Sisters with a brief overview of the Code of Ethics, its purpose, and the importance of adhering to sorority policies. They should also explain the potential consequences of policy or Code of Ethics violations.

Additionally, the Chapter SAA can share best practices for maintaining order during meetings and offer feedback to help the process function smoothly. They may also acknowledge that working together as a group can be challenging and emphasize that collaboration requires patience, respect, and time. This message is especially important during the process, as Little Sisters may not always agree, but despite differences, they must support one another in pursuit of shared goals.

Goal: To help Little Sisters understand the importance of the sorority's Code of Ethics, the role of the Chapter Sergeant at Arms, and how to foster mutual respect, accountability, and teamwork throughout the process.

Activities:

1. **Scholarship Research Presentations**

The Pledge Mother(s) will allocate time during this meeting to allow the Little Sisters to present their slides (1-3 slides maximum). Each presentation should outline their chosen field of interest, scholarship/internship objectives and requirements, and describe why their selections align with their academic or career goals. Depending on the size of the Pledge Class, the Pledge Mother(s) should determine in advance how much time each Little Sister will be allotted to present.

2. **Big Sister Little Sister Potluck**

The Pledge Mother(s) along with the designated Big Sister Committee must plan to host the potluck by Meeting 5 (Week 4), as the assignments to be assigned at this meeting relate to their Personal Big Sister. As previously noted, the Big Sister Committee may begin planning (tentative dates and locations) at the beginning of the process to ensure the potluck can be completed in time.

Knowledge to Assign:

1. Founding Chapter History

Assignments:

1. **Family Traditions and Cultural Project (Due Meeting 6)**

Each Little Sister will complete a project that highlights a culture and/or family traditions. This may reflect their own culture, their biological family, or their chosen family.

Alternatively, they may choose to explore a culture or family traditions that they are interested in learning about and potentially incorporating into their life.

The format of the project is open-ended and can take any creative form, such as artwork, a video, a performance, a presentation board, a PowerPoint, or any other medium that meaningfully expresses their chosen culture or traditions.

Each Little Sister will present their project, sharing why the chosen culture or traditions are meaningful to them. After all presentations, the Pledge Mother(s) will lead a group discussion on cultural diversity and sensitivity.

Purpose: To encourage self-expression and cultural awareness by exploring and honoring family traditions and diverse identities. This assignment fosters Cultura, one of Sigma Omega Nu's core objectives, by creating space for Little Sisters to share meaningful aspects of their heritage and interests while promoting inclusivity within the Pledge Class.

Objective: Cultura

2. Big Sister Little Sister Date (Due Meeting 7)

Each Little Sister and their Personal Big Sister are expected to spend quality time together on a planned "Big/Little Date". This can be done individually or as part of a group activity with other Big/Little pairs. A minimum of four hours should be dedicated to the experience to allow for meaningful connect and conversation. Following the date, the Little Sister will complete a journal entry reflecting on the time spent and what they learned about their Big Sister.

Purpose: Now that they have been matched with their Big Sister, this is their opportunity to deepen that relationship. While they chose them for a reason, there is still so much to learn about each other. This experience is meant to build trust, friendship, and lasting memories as they continue their journey through the process.

Objective: Sisterhood & Relationship Building

3. Big Sister Paddle (Due Meeting 7)

The Little Sisters must each decorate a paddle for their Personal Big Sisters. The paddle size, shape, and style shall be left up to the discretion of each Little Sister. The paddle must contain the following:

- a. The Greek Letters ΣΩΝ
- b. Big Sister's Name
- c. Big Sister's Class, Number, and Nickname
- d. Little Sister's Name
- e. Pledge Class Name
- f. Term and Year of Pledgeship

In exchange for creating and gifting a paddle to their Big Sister, each Little Sister will receive gifts from their Big Sister at the Crossover Ceremony. This exchange is a meaningful tradition that symbolizes mutual appreciation, support, and the special bond formed throughout the pledgeship process.

Purpose: To honor the bond between Big and Little Sisters through a personalized and symbolic gift that reflects appreciation, tradition, and the shared journey of the process.

Objective: Sisterhood

4. **Journal Question #7 (Due Meeting 6):** How did you feel about the Big Sister Little Sister Potluck/Big Sister Reveal experience?
5. **Journal Question #8 (Due Meeting 6):** What was is like learning who your Big Sister is?

Meeting 6 (Week 5)

Introduction: Chapter Commissioner(s) of Cultura and Sisterhood

The Pledge Mother(s) should determine in advance how much time the Chapter Commissioner(s) of Cultura and Sisterhood will be allotted to present.

Cultura and Sisterhood are two of the three objectives of the sorority. During this meeting, the Chapter Commissioner(s) will be invited to share their roles and responsibilities. These include organizing cultural events, planning retreats and sisterhood socials, selecting Sister(s) of the Month, and coordinating the chapter's Parent's Banquet.

The Commissioner(s) should also share what inspired them to take on their roles and explain the significance of their work in promoting unity and cultural appreciation within the chapter. If time allows, they may lead a sisterhood activity for the Little Sisters or share strategies they have used to build sisterhood, offering ideas that the Pledge Class can apply among themselves during the process.

Goals: To introduce Little Sisters to the role of the Commissioner of Cultura and Sisterhood, highlight the importance of cultural engagement and sisterhood within the sorority, and provide ideas or activities to strengthen their bond as a Pledge Class.

Activity:

1. Family Tradition Presentations

The Pledge Mother(s) will allocate time during the meeting for Little Sisters to present their project. Each Little Sister will share why the chosen culture or traditions are meaningful to them. Depending on the size of the Pledge Class, the Pledge Mother(s) must determine in advance how much time will be allotted for each Little Sister. After the presentations, the Pledge Mother(s) will lead a group discussion on cultural diversity and sensitivity.

Knowledge to Assign:

1. Chapter History

Assignments:

1. Scholarship Pursuit: Part 3 Application

Little Sisters need to have applied or completed their applications by the second to last meeting of the process and submit a confirmation screenshot of email to the Pledge Mother(s).

2. Sexual Assault Awareness Research (Due Meeting 7)

Each Little Sister will research and write a research paper (no more than two pages) on the prevalence of sexual assault in the Greek community, and our role as a sorority in reduction and prevention. As a group, the Little Sisters will then create a visual project (for example, a

PowerPoint or poster board presentation) to share about what they learned. Once the Little Sisters have shared their presentation, the Pledge Mother(s) will lead a group discussion to answer questions, but to also reflect on what they can continue to do for their community.

Purpose: This assignment is intended to raise awareness about the prevalence of sexual assault within the Greek community and to educate Little Sisters on the critical role sororities play in prevention, advocacy, and support. By engaging in individual research, collaborative learning, and open discussion, Little Sisters will develop a deeper understanding on the systemic issues involved, the importance of survivor-centered support, and how Sigma Omega Nu upholds values of accountability and education. This assignment also empowers them to become informed advocates and responsible leaders within both the sorority and the wider community.

Objective: Awareness and Community Responsibility

3. Sigma Omega Nu Family Tree (Check-In Meeting 8)

Each Little Sister is encouraged to create a family tree that traces their Sigma Omega Nu lineage. This is an open-ended, creative project and is meant for personal knowledge and reflection. Collaboration with their Big Sister and other members of their lineage is highly encouraged.

Only one copy of the family tree is required, and the design, format, and size are entirely up to the Little Sister. This assignment is not testable or graded, but serves as a meaningful connection to their sorority roots.

Purpose: Their family tree is a visual representation of the sisterhood they are joining. It is a chance to learn about the women who came before them, including their direct lineage and the Eight Founding Mothers of Sigma Omega Nu. This project helps build a deeper sense of belonging, history, and pride within the sorority.

Objective: Sorority History

4. Journal Question #9 (Due Meeting 7): How did the Family Traditions presentations help you understand the values or culture of different Pledge Sisters?

Meeting 7 (Week 6)

Introduction: Chapter Risk Management Officer

The Pledge Mother(s) should determine in advance how much time the Chapter President will be allotted to present.

In the previous meeting, the Pledge Mother(s) assigned the Little Sisters to research sexual assault, its prevalence within the Greek community, and the role sororities can play in its prevention and reduction. In this meeting, the Chapter Risk Management Officer should discuss how Sigma Omega Nu educates its members on this issue and outline the relevant policies the sorority has in place.

They should also share local and national resources available for learning more about sexual assault and for supporting survivors. If applicable, the Risk Management Officer may explain any current organizational disaffiliations at their university, including what disaffiliation means and why it matters.

While the Chapter Risk Management Officer has a broad role within the chapter, the focus of this meeting should be promoting member and community safety, specifically in relation to sexual assault awareness and prevention.

Goal: To educate Little Sisters on sexual assault awareness and prevention with the Greek community, highlight Sigma Omega Nu's policies and resources, and emphasize the sorority's commitment to member and community safety.

Activities:

1. Practice Informational

The Pledge Mother(s) will allocate time during the meeting for Little Sisters to hold a practice informational. Since two practice informationals may be held (one during this meeting and one during the following meeting), the Pledge Mother(s) may divide the Pledge Class into two groups, to allow for smaller groups and more focused practice informationals. Each Little Sister is required to present at least once. The Pledge Mother(s) must determine in advance how much time will be allotted for each presentation.

2. Sexual Assault Awareness Presentation

The Pledge Mother(s) will allocate time during the meeting for the Pledge Class to present their findings on the prevalence of sexual assault in the Greek community, and their role as sorority in reduction and prevention. The Pledge Mother(s) must determine in advance how much time will be allotted for the presentation. After the presentation, the Pledge Mother(s) must lead a group discussion to answer questions, and reflect on how the Pledge Class and Chapter can continue to support awareness, advocacy, and safety within their community.

3. Candlelight Closing (Person of Importance)

The Candlelight Closing Ceremony must take place immediately following the meeting. All Active Members are required to attend and participate.

All attendees (Little Sisters and Big Sisters) will receive a white candle and are to form a circle (either seated or standing). The Pledge Mother(s) will begin by explaining the purpose of the ceremony, to reflect on and celebrate the bonds being built during the process. Little Sisters will each share about a Pledge Sister who has made a meaningful impact on them during the process, and Big Sisters will each share about their personal Little Sister, highlighting something they admire, appreciate, or have witnessed as growth. To surprise the Little Sisters on the Big Sister portion, the Pledge Mother(s) will share the instructions with the Big Sisters at a chapter meeting.

To begin, the Pledge Mother(s) will light their candle and share briefly about the importance of building sisterhood within the chapter. They will then light the candle of the first Little Sister in the circle. Each Little Sister will share a short reflection about a Pledge Sister who has positively impacted them, and then light the candle of the Pledge Sister to their left.

After all Little Sisters have shared, the Big Sisters will then take turns sharing about their individual Little Sister(s) and light each other's candles. Once everyone has spoken and all candles are lit, the Pledge Mother(s) will guide the group to blow out their candles together simultaneously, and thank everyone for sharing.

Purpose: To honor the meaningful relationships formed during the process and strengthen the bonds of sisterhood.

Objective: Sisterhood & Relationship Building

Assignments:

1. Chant (Due Meeting 8)

The Pledge Class will be assigned to write their own class chant. Sigma Omega Nu has official chants that are used once members are initiated. To provide inspiration and context, the Pledge Mother(s) will first share the official chants, along with examples of past Pledge Class chants, including their own. The chant's style and structure are entirely up to the creativity of the Pledge Class, but must include the following:

- a. Chapter Name
- b. Chapter Establishment Date
- c. Sorority Colors
- d. Chapter Objectives
- e. Name of all Little Sisters
- f. Pledge Class Name

A written copy of the chant must be submitted to the Pledge Mother(s). Little Sisters are not required to perform the chant, but may do so if they comfortable. If performed, the Pledge Class can decide whether the chant will be performed by the entire group or by a few selected members.

Purpose: The chant serves as a creative expression of their pledge class identity, highlighting their shared experiences and individual voices. It also introduces them to the tradition of chanting within Sigma Omega Nu and celebrates their connection to the chapter's legacy.

Objective: Sorority History & Class Representation

2. Chapter Founding Sister(s) & Alumnae Panel Questions (Due Meeting 8)

Each Little Sister must prepare 1-2 thoughtful questions to potentially ask during the panel. Questions may explore the Chapter's history, the Sister's personal experiences (such as academic, career, or sorority related), or seek advice about the process and becoming a Sister.

Purpose: To encourage meaningful engagement with Chapter history and alumnae experiences.

Objective: Relationship Building & Networking

3. Journal Question #10 (Due Meeting 8): Which activity or assignment have you enjoyed the most so far, and why?

Meeting 8 (Week 7)

Introduction: Chapter Commissioner(s) of Alumnae Relations

As part of the alumnae panel in this meeting, the Chapter's Commissioner of Alumnae Relations will be invited to share their role and how they help maintain engagement with alumnae. Joining Sigma Omega Nu is a lifelong commitment that extends beyond undergraduate years. While the Little Sisters may be entering the organization as a class, they are becoming part of a larger network of Sisters, both from their own chapter and from chapters across multiple states. It is important for

them to begin building relationships within this network, as all members share common values and a deep love for the organization.

Goal: To introduce Little Sisters to the lifelong commitment of Sigma Omega Nu by highlighting alumnae involvement, the role of the Commissioner of Alumnae Relations, and the importance of building connections within the wider sisterhood network.

Activities:

1. Practice Informational

The Pledge Mother(s) will allocate time during the meeting for Little Sisters to hold a practice informational. Since two practice informationals may be held (one during the previous meeting and one during this meeting), the Pledge Mother(s) may divide the Pledge Class into two groups, to allow for smaller groups and more focused practice informationals. Each Little Sister is required to present at least once. The Pledge Mother(s) must determine in advance how much time will be allotted for each presentation.

2. Chapter Founding Sister(s) & Alumnae Panel

The Pledge Class will participate in a panel featuring Chapter Founding Sisters and/or Alumnae. The Pledge Mother(s) will coordinate the panel's time and date, as well as confirm participants availability beforehand.

Following the panel, Little Sisters are encouraged to send a thank you email to 1-2 members of the panel with whom they felt a strong connection. This provides an opportunity to practice professional communication and begin building relationships with the broader Sigma Omega Nu network. The Pledge Mother(s) may also host a brief workshop to help Little Sisters craft thoughtful, well-written thank you messages.

Purpose: Sigma Omega Nu's sisterhood extends far beyond current membership. Hundreds of sisters have come before them, many of whom remain actively connected to the organization. This panel offers a unique opportunity to learn from their experiences, gain insight into the lasting impact of sisterhood, and begin building their own network within the Sigma Omega Nu community.

Objective: Relationship Building & Networking

3. **Journal Question #11 (Due by Crossover):** What kind of support would be most helpful to you from the Sisters during the rest of the process?
4. **Journal Question #12 (Due by Crossover):** Are there any questions or concerns you haven't had a chance to share yet?

Knowledge to Assign:

1. Founders Quote

Assignments:

1. Class Gift Fundraiser (Due by Crossover)

The purpose of this fundraiser is to raise funds for a class gift to the Chapter. While the planning and proposal must be completed before Crossover, the execution of the fundraiser will be carried out by the Chapter after Crossover. The Pledge Class will work with the Pledge Mother(s) to develop a detailed plan, including logistics, tentative budget and

promotional ideas. Once crossed, the chapter will discuss and provide input on potential gifts that would be useful and meaningful, as the final gift will become property of the Chapter.

Purpose: This assignment gives their class the opportunity to leave a lasting impact on the Chapter. It promotes collaboration, creativity, and thoughtful contribution. The gift should be practical, durable, and serve as a long-term benefit to Sigma Omega Nu.

Objective: Event Planning & Class Representation

Appendix B: Interview Evaluation Rubric

Questions	Category	Description	Rating Scale	Comments
What do you hope to gain from being a part of Sigma Omega Nu? Sigma Omega Nu's objectives are Academics, Cultura, and Sisterhood. If you may please share what each means to you.	Alignment with their goals and Sigma Omega Nu's Objectives	Demonstrates an understanding of the sorority's core objectives, mission, and vision.	1-5 (1 = Poor/No Evidence, 3 = Average/Meets expectations, 5 = Excellent/Exceeds expectations)	
Can you tell us about a time when you had to be a leader or a team player? What is your approach to teamwork and collaboration?	Teamwork & Collaboration	Demonstrates ability to work effectively in groups, cooperate with others, and contribute to team success	1-5 (1 = Poor/No Evidence, 3 = Average/Meets expectations, 5 = Excellent/Exceeds expectations)	
What extracurricular activities or volunteer work have you been a part of or that you are passionate about?	Community Involvement	Evidence of past involvement in school, community, or extracurricular activities.	1-5 (1 = Poor/No Evidence, 3 = Average/Meets expectations, 5 = Excellent/Exceeds expectations)	
As an individual, what can you contribute to Sigma Omega Nu? Returning: Since you have pledged in the past and have an idea of what to expect,	Enthusiasm & Passion for Joining	Displays genuine interest in becoming a member of the sorority and contributing to its activities.	1-5 (1 = Poor/No Evidence, 3 = Average/Meets expectations, 5 = Excellent/Exceeds expectations)	

what strategies have you identified for yourself to help you succeed through Pledgeship?				
What are some challenges you have faced, and how did you overcome them? What is something you have learned about yourself in the past year?	Personal Integrity	Demonstrates honesty, accountability, and strong ethical standards in personal and academic life.	1-5 (1 = Poor/No Evidence, 3 = Average/Meets expectations, 5 = Excellent/Exceeds expectations)	
How do you support others when they are going through tough times?	Emotional Intelligence	Ability to empathize, understand, and navigate social situations with maturity and respect.	1-5 (1 = Poor/No Evidence, 3 = Average/Meets expectations, 5 = Excellent/Exceeds expectations)	
	Overall Impression	General impression of the PLS based on their interview, personality, and potential fit within the sorority.	1-5 (1 = Poor/No Evidence, 3 = Average/Meets expectations, 5 = Excellent/Exceeds expectations)	

Total Score: ____/____

Recommendation: Yes/No

Appendix C: Progress Interviews

Questions	Category	Description	Rating Scale	Comments
Looking back on your pledgeship experience, what has been your biggest area of growth? What have you learned about yourself throughout the process?	Personal Growth and Reflection	Demonstrates self-awareness and the ability to reflect on personal development throughout pledgeship.	1-5 (1 = Poor/No Evidence, 3 = Average/Meets expectations, 5 = Excellent/Exceeds expectations)	
How have you demonstrated Sigma Omega Nu's values of Academics, Cultura, and Sisterhood throughout pledgeship? Can you provide an example?	Understanding of Sigma Omega Nu's Values	Demonstrates understanding and application of the sorority's objectives, mission, and expectations during pledgeship.	1-5 (1 = Poor/No Evidence, 3 = Average/Meets expectations, 5 = Excellent/Exceeds expectations)	
How have you contributed to your pledge class and the chapter during this process?	Teamwork & Sisterhood	Demonstrates collaboration, reliability, communication, and commitment to fostering a positive	1-5 (1 = Poor/No Evidence, 3 = Average/Meets expectations, 5 = Excellent/Exceeds expectations)	

Describe a time you supported another Little Sister.		sisterhood experience.		
What has been the most challenging part of pledgeship, and how did you overcome it? What strategies helped you remain successful?	Resilience & Accountability	Demonstrates perseverance, responsibility, problem-solving, and the ability to seek support when needed.	1-5 (1 = Poor/No Evidence, 3 = Average/Meets expectations, 5 = Excellent/Exceeds expectations)	
What is one lesson from pledgeship that you will carry into active membership? How do you plan to continue contributing after crossover?	Commitment to Continued Membership	Demonstrates readiness to transition into active membership and commitment to continued involvement and personal growth.	1-5 (1 = Poor/No Evidence, 3 = Average/Meets expectations, 5 = Excellent/Exceeds expectations)	
How have you balanced academics, personal responsibilities, and pledgeship?	Responsibility & Time Management	Demonstrates accountability, organization, and the ability to manage responsibilities while maintaining	1-5 (1 = Poor/No Evidence, 3 = Average/Meets expectations, 5 = Excellent/Exceeds expectations)	

		chapter expectations.		
	Overall Impression	Overall assessment of the Little Sister's growth, preparedness for active membership, professionalism, and engagement throughout pledgship.	1-5 (1 = Poor/No Evidence, 3 = Average/Meets expectations, 5 = Excellent/Exceeds expectations)	

Total Score: ____/____

Constructive Feedback

Strengths:

Areas for Continued Growth:

Recommendations for Active Membership:

Appendix D: Assignment Rubrics

Big Sister Paddle Rubric

Big Sister Paddle: 5 Points		
Criteria	Description	Max Points
Required Elements Included	Includes all 6 required components: - Greek Letters - Big Sister's Name - Big Sister's Scroll - Little Sister's Name - Pledge Class Name - Term & Year	1 Point
Creativity & Personalization	Design reflects thought, personality, and meaningful touches. 1 point - Includes unique elements clearly referencing Big/Little's personalities or shared experiences. 0.5 point - Some personal effort visible, but minimal detail or generic design. 0 points - No visible personalization or symbolism.	1 Point
Effort & Craftsmanship	Neat and carefully crafted 1 point - Clean, well-constructed paddle with care shown. 0.5 point - Some flaws, but generally presentable. 0 points - Messy, rushed, or structurally incomplete.	1 Point
Completeness	Paddle is fully completed	1 Point
Timeliness	Turned in on or before the deadline	1 Point
Comments		

Budgeting 101: Tentative Budget Rubric

Budgeting 101 Tentative Budget: 5 Points		
Criteria	Description	Max Points
Complete Budget Breakdown	Budget includes itemized categories (for example, food, decorations, supplies, venue) with estimated costs	1 Point
Accuracy & Realism	Prices are reasonable and show effort to research or approximate realistic costs	1 Point
Follows Assignment Guidelines	Budget aligns with the assigned event, number of members, and/or given budget maximum	1 Point
Organization	Budget is clearly laid out, labeled, and easy to read	1 Point
Timeliness	Turned in on or before the deadline	1 Point
Comments		

Chapter Officer Interviews Rubric

Chapter Officer Interviews: 5 Points		
Criteria	Description	Max Points
Number of Interviews Completed	Interviewed 2-3 officers of interest	1 Point
Relevant and Thoughtful Questions	Asked questions that show genuine interest and relate to officer duties and responsibilities	1 Point
Journal Documentation	Interviews are clearly recorded in the journal and labeled properly	1 Point
Depth of Reflection	Entries show understanding of the officer's role and include personal takeaways or interests	1 Point
Timeliness	Turned in on or before the deadline	1 Point
Comments		

Class Gift Fundraiser Rubric

Class Gift Fundraiser: 5 Points		
Criteria	Description	Max Points
Detailed Fundraiser Plan	Clearly outlines the type of fundraiser, purpose, timeline, and roles	1 Point
Tentative Budget	Includes projected costs, fundraising goals, and estimated profit	1 Point
Logistics & Feasibility	Plan addresses event setup, location, materials needed, scheduling, and overall practicality	1 Point
Promotional Strategy	Outlines how the fundraiser will be advertised (for example, flyers, social media)	1 Point
Team Collaboration	Reflects effort from the whole pledge class	1 Point
Comments		

Family Traditions & Cultura Project Rubric

Family Traditions & Cultura Project: 5 Points		
Criteria	Description	Max Points
Clarity & Personal Connection	Project clearly explains the chosen culture/tradition and why it is personally meaningful	1 Point
Depth of Exploration	Goes beyond surface-level details; shares personal stories, family context, or thoughtful insights	1 Point
Creativity & Effort	Demonstrates care in presentation format and creative expression	1 Point
Presentation Quality	Communicated ideas clearly and confidently during the presentation	1 Point
Timeliness	Project was completed and presented on time	1 Point
Comments		

Pledge Class T-shirt Design Rubric

Pledge Class T-shirt Design: 5 Points		
Criteria	Description	Max Points
Required Elements Included	Design includes all required components: - Sigma Omega Nu - Chapter Name - University Name/Location - Pledge Class Nickname - First Names of all members - Term & Year of Pledgeship	1 Point
Creativity & Originality	Design is visually engaging and reflects the personality or theme of the class	1 Point
Effort & Presentation Quality	Shows care and effort in execution, regardless of whether it was handmade or professionally made	1 Point
Team Collaboration	Evidence of input and cooperation from all pledge class members	1 Point
Timeliness	Design finalized and submitted by the assigned deadline	1 Point
Comments		

Journal Decoration Rubric

Journal Decoration: 5 Points		
Criteria	Description	Max Points
Decoration	Both front and back covers are decorated	2 Points
Name Displayed Clearly	Little Sister's name is clearly visible on the front cover	1 Point
Creativity & Personality	Decorations reflect the individual's personality and thoughtful creative effort	1 Point
Timeliness	Journal was decorated and submitted by the assigned deadline	1 Point
Comments		

Sexual Assault Awareness Research Rubric

Sexual Assault Awareness Research: 10 Points		
Criteria	Description	Max Points
Individual Research Paper: 6 Points		
Focus & Content	Clearly addresses the prevalence of sexual assault in the Greek community and the sorority's role in prevention	2 Points
Research & Accuracy	Uses credible sources, information is factual, relevant, and cited	1 Point
Reflection & Insight	Provides thoughtful analysis on personal and organizational responsibility and potential actions	1 Point
Structure & Clarity	Organized, well written, and stays within the two-page limit	1 Point
Timeliness	Submitted on or before the deadline	1 Point
Group Presentation: 4 Points		
Collaboration & Contribution	Active participation in group project; effort is evident in final presentation	1 Point
Visual Quality & Clarity	Information is presented in a clear, visually organized, and engaging format	1 Point
Message & Relevance	Effectively communicates key learnings from individual research and promotes awareness	1 Point
Presentation & Communication	Group presents clearly and respectfully during the discussion.	1 Point
Comments:		

Big Sister Interviews Rubric

Big Sister Interviews: 10 Points		
Criteria	Description	Max Points
Interview Completion	Completed interviews with all eligible Big Sisters (or participated fully in group interviews if needed)	2 Points
Scheduling Effort	Demonstrated initiative in scheduling; communicated respectfully and in a timely manner	2 Points
Preparedness	Came to each interview with relevant, thoughtful, and respectful questions	1 Point
Active Engagement	Displayed active listening, follow-up questions, and genuine interest in the conversation	1 Point
Journal Documentation	Interviews are clearly recorded in the journal and labeled properly	2 Points
Neatness & Organization	Journal is legible, organized, and easy to follow	1 Point
Timeliness	All interviews and journal entries were completed and submitted by the deadline	1 Point
Comments		

Pledge Class Fundraiser Rubric

Pledge Class Fundraiser: 10 Points		
Criteria	Description	Max Points
Detailed Fundraiser Plan	Clearly outlines the type of fundraiser, purpose, timeline, and roles. Plan addresses event setup, location, materials needed, and scheduling.	2 Points
Tentative Budget	Tentative budget provided before the event and includes projected costs, fundraising goals, and estimated profit.	2 Points
Promotional Strategy/Effort	Outlines how the fundraiser will be advertised (for example, flyers, social media), and was promoted effectively and with effort.	1 Point
Execution	Event was well organized, with appropriate roles, location, timing, and materials.	1 Point
Fundraising Goal & Outcome	Realistic goal set and effort made to reach or exceed it; results were documented in the financial report submitted by the Fundraising Chair.	2 Points
Team Collaboration	Evidence of collaboration, reflects effort from the whole pledge class.	2 Points
Comments		

Pledge Class Interviews Rubric

Pledge Class Interviews: 10 Points		
Criteria	Description	Max Points
Interview Completion	Interviewed all Pledge Class members one-on-one	2 Points
Scheduling Effort	Demonstrated initiative in scheduling; communicated respectfully and in a timely manner	2 Points
Preparedness	Came to each interview with relevant, thoughtful, and respectful questions	1 Point
Active Engagement	Displayed active listening, follow-up questions, and genuine interest in the conversation	1 Point
Journal Documentation	Interviews are clearly recorded in the journal and labeled properly	2 Points
Neatness & Organization	Journal is legible, organized, and easy to follow	1 Point
Timeliness	All interviews and journal entries were completed and submitted by the deadline	1 Point
Comments		

Pledge Class Paddle Rubric

Pledge Class Paddle: 10 Points		
Criteria	Description	Max Points
Required Elements Included	Includes all of the following: - Greek Letters - Pledge Class Name (Nickname Option) - Full Names (First & Last) of all Pledge Class Members - Term & Year of Pledgeship	2 Points
Use of Sorority Colors	Sorority colors are clearly used in the design and decoration	1 Point
Creativity & Class Representation	Design reflects group effort, creativity, and class identity. 2 points - Includes unique elements clearly referencing Big/Little's personalities or shared experiences. 1 point - Some personal effort visible, but minimal detail or generic design. 0 points - No visible personalization or symbolism.	2 Points
Effort & Craftsmanship	Paddle is neat, durable, and visibly well-made. 2 points - Clean, well-constructed paddle with care shown. 1 point - Some flaws, but generally presentable. 0 points - Messy, rushed, or structurally incomplete.	2 Points
Practical Size & Shape	Paddle is appropriately sized for handling and public display	1 Point
Team Collaboration	Evidence of shared input and participation from the pledge class	1 Point
Timeliness	Turned in on or before the deadline	1 Point
Comments		

Scholarship Pursuit: Research, Presentation, and Application Rubric

Scholarship Pursuit: 10 Points		
Part 1 - Research: 3 Points		
Criteria	Description	Max Points
Number & Relevance of Opportunities	Identified at least 3 scholarships or internships related to their academic or career/field	1 Point
Eligibility & Quality	Each opportunity meets meaningful criteria (not just "enter email" offers) and includes eligibility details	1 Point
Links & Clarity	Accurate direct links are submitted, clearly presented for review	1 Point
Part 2 - Presentation: 3 Points		
Field of Interest Explained	Clearly communicates chosen academic or career focus	1 Point
Opportunity Alignment	Effectively explains why the selected opportunities are a good match	1 Point
Organization & Slide Design	1-3 slides are well organized and informative	1 Point
Part 3 - Application Submission: 4 Points		
Application Completion	Applied to at least one opportunity before the deadline	2 Points
Confirmation Submitted	Provided screenshot or email confirmation to the Pledge Mother(s)	1 Point
Timeliness	All parts completed by the designated deadline	1 Point
Comments		